



THE GUARDIANS OF ELARIA

THE COMPENDIUM

**Bestiary, Treasures, Custom Content & Character
Sheets**

A running reference for The Guardians of Elaria. Updated as the chronicle grows.



Every wonder of the road, gathered in one book.

One volume for everything the road has taught the Guardians: every creature they have faced, freed, or befriended; every treasure and relic they carry; the house rules, homebrew paths, and mysteries of this table; and the heroes' own character sheets, ready for the table. Four parts, one book, growing with the chronicle.

Part I: The Bestiary



Here is every creature the Guardians have faced, freed, or befriended, gathered with its lore and its complete statistics. When a planar creature falls, it leaves no body: a gleaming mote of its home plane rises, hangs a moment, and fades (and the Essence Sphere tugs toward it). Read on, brave heroes, and know your monsters.

◆ LORE OF ELARIA ◆ The Wakened

The scholars of Ravenstone keep trying to sort the wondrous creatures of the Darkening into families, and the creatures keep declining. A duck with a leek. A fish that swims through air. A plant that chose three children. The only taxonomy that has ever held is the Circle's: some things wake up when the worlds lean close, and what they become depends entirely on who finds them first.

Companions & Friends

Not every creature in this book is an enemy. Some walk the road beside the Guardians.

◆ LORE OF ELARIA ◆ Why the Guardians

The Warden's safeguards do not choose the strong. Every tale of the scattered gifts agrees on this one point: they choose the kind, because kindness is the only power Maldrith has never once predicted correctly. The friends who walk beside the Guardians were won the same way, one small mercy at a time.

Ghostbloom is the party's dearest companion, chosen in Session 3 as Floraburst, changed aboard the sinking Dutchman and again in Wraithpine's ghost-light. Her petals are glass-pale now and chime like frost; she floats, speaks in soft telepathy, and glows brighter near planar wounds. Some say she is Elaria's own little voice.

GHOSTBLOOM, SPECTRAL BLOSSOM

Tiny fey (Ghost/Grass), chaotic good ◆ the party's companion

AC 15 (natural armor) **HP** 52 (8d4 + 32) **Speed** 30 ft., fly 30 ft. (hover)

STR 8 **DEX** 18 **CON** 18 **INT** 12 **WIS** 14 **CHA** 16

Saves Dex +7, Con +7, Wis +5 **Skills** Perception +5, Stealth +7

Vulnerable fire, cold (mind the friendly fire)

Resist necrotic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Imm. (cond) charmed, frightened

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 15

Languages Sylvan, telepathy 30 ft. (to her keeper)

Traits

Fey Step (1/Short Rest). As a bonus action, teleport up to 20 ft. to an unoccupied space she can see. Her next attack this turn has advantage.

Spectral Form. She can move through creatures and objects as difficult terrain. If she ends her turn inside an object, she is shunted to the nearest space and takes 5 force damage.

Guardian's Light (3/Short Rest). *Reaction, 30 ft.* When an ally she can see takes damage, that ally regains 1d8 + 3 hit points and immediately ends the charmed or frightened condition on itself.

Actions

Multiattack. She makes two Spectral Lash attacks.

Spectral Lash. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 15 ft., one target. *Hit:* 9 (1d8 + 5) slashing plus 3 (1d6) necrotic, and the target must succeed on a DC 15 Wisdom save or be frightened until the end of its next turn.

Ghostly Wail (1/Long Rest). A haunting cry in a 15-ft. cone. Each creature there makes a DC 15 Wisdom save, taking 14 (4d6) necrotic and frightened until the end of its next turn on a fail, or half damage and no fear on a success.

Dread Shroud. *Bonus Action, 30 ft., one creature.* A chill bloom settles over the target: DC 15 Wisdom save or disadvantage on all attack rolls until the start of her next turn.



◆ LORE OF ELARIA ◆ The Kept Company

The sky-readers keep a gentler list beside their catalogue of frights: the wonders that chose to stay. A creature woken by the Darkening can turn wild or turn kind, and the Circle has never found a rule for which, only a pattern, that the ones met with a shared meal and a true name tend to follow the heroes home. A companion, the old teaching runs, is a mote that decided to belong to someone. They are counted among the Guardians' truest treasures, and guarded twice as fiercely for having been freely given.

Floraburst, as she was before the change: a leafy sprout-backed creature who loved sunlight and berries. This is the form the party first knew and loved in Session 3.

FLORABURST

Small fey, neutral good ◆ the companion as she was chosen

AC 14 (natural armor) **HP** 45 (6d6 + 18) **Speed** 30 ft.

STR 14 **DEX** 12 **CON** 16 **INT** 10 **WIS** 14 **CHA** 10

Skills Nature +4, Survival +4 **Resist** poison

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 12

Languages understands Sylvan and Common but cannot speak

Traits

Plant Camouflage. Advantage on Stealth checks to hide in heavy foliage.

Photosynthesis. During a short or long rest in sunlight, Floraburst recovers 10 extra hit points.

Actions

Razor Leaf. Ranged Weapon Attack: +4 to hit, range 30 ft., one target. *Hit:* 10 (2d8 + 2) slashing.

Vine Lash. Melee Weapon Attack: +4 to hit, reach 15 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d10 + 2) bludgeoning, and the target must succeed on a DC 13 Strength save or be restrained until the end of its next turn.

Floraberry (3/Day). Floraburst produces 1d4 + 1 magical berries. A creature can use a Bonus Action to eat one and restore 3 hit points (house rule 4, as Goodberry).



◆ LORE OF ELARIA ◆ Motes

A mote is a crumb of another world, and the world it lands in treats it the way a pond treats a dropped lantern: strange light, strange ripples, and every fish in the pond suddenly having opinions. The wondrous creatures of the chronicle, the talking, glowing, impossible ones, are what happens when the ripples reach something alive.

In Session 3, Professor Aelwyn offered the party three little wards; they chose Floraburst. The two who stayed behind, Aqualump and Emberpaws, are catalogued here too, for they are part of the story.

AQUALUMP

Small elemental, neutral good ♦ stayed with Aelwyn



AC 16 (natural armor, Shell Defense) **HP** 54 (7d6 + 21)
Speed 25 ft., swim 30 ft.
STR 15 **DEX** 14 **CON** 17 **INT** 10 **WIS** 13 **CHA** 11
Skills Athletics +4, Perception +3 **Resist** cold
Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 13
Languages understands Aquan and Common but cannot speak

Traits

Shell Defense. As a bonus action, Aqualump withdraws into its shell, gaining +4 AC until the start of its next turn; while in its shell its speed is 0.

Water Veil. Aqualump cannot be set on fire and has advantage on saves against being ignited or burned.

Actions

Water Bolt. Ranged Weapon Attack: +4 to hit, range 30 ft., one target. *Hit:* 10 (2d8 + 2) bludgeoning, and the target must succeed on a DC 14 Strength save or be knocked prone.

Surf (Recharge 5-6). A 15-ft. cone of water. Each creature there makes a DC 14 Dexterity save, taking 14 (4d6) cold on a fail (half on a success); those who fail are knocked prone.

Frost Shell. Ranged Weapon Attack: +4 to hit, range 20 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d10 + 2) cold, and the target's speed is reduced by 10 ft. until the end of its next turn.

EMBERPAWS

Small elemental, chaotic good ♦ stayed with Aelwyn



AC 15 (natural armor) **HP** 42 (6d6 + 15)
Speed 30 ft.
STR 13 **DEX** 16 **CON** 15 **INT** 10 **WIS** 12 **CHA** 12
Skills Acrobatics +5, Perception +3 **Imm.** fire
Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 13
Languages understands Ignan and Common but cannot speak

Traits

Fiery Spirit. When reduced to 0 hit points, Emberpaws bursts into flame. Each creature within 10 ft. makes a DC 13 Dexterity save, taking 7 (2d6) fire on a fail (half on a success).

Heatwave (3/Day). As a bonus action, Emberpaws radiates heat for 1 minute; any creature that hits it with a melee attack takes 4 (1d8) fire.

Actions

Ember. Ranged Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, range 30 ft., one target. *Hit:* 9 (2d6 + 2) fire.

Bite. Melee Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d8 + 3) piercing.

Tail Flame Whip. Melee Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 10 (2d6 + 3) fire, and the target must succeed on a DC 13 Dexterity save or be ignited, taking 2 (1d4) fire at the start of each of its turns until the flames are put out.

Lickgloom was the party's very first friend, met on their first night by a pond in the Forest of Whispers: round-bodied, endlessly curious, with a tongue longer than it is tall and a telepathic voice of pure feeling ('Food? Friend?'). It chose to stay among Professor Aelwyn's creatures at Ravenstone. Visits are owed.

LICKGLOOM

Small fey (Feywild), neutral ♦ CR 1 (200 XP) ♦ the first friend

AC 13 (natural armor) **HP** 27 (5d6 + 10) **Speed** 30 ft.

STR 14 **DEX** 12 **CON** 14 **INT** 6 **WIS** 10 **CHA** 8

Saves Dex +3 **Skills** Perception +2, Stealth +4

Resist acid, poison

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 12

Languages understands Common but cannot speak; telepathic impressions

Challenge 1 (200 XP)

Traits

Helpful Tongue. Traveling with the party, Lickgloom can fetch small objects with its 10 foot tongue, and once per scene its tasting tongue grants one hero advantage on a Wisdom (Perception) or Intelligence (Investigation) check.

Actions

Tongue Whip. *Melee Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 10 ft. *Hit:* 1d6 + 2 bludgeoning, and the target must succeed on a DC 12 Strength saving throw or be grappled (escape DC 12).

Sticky Lick (Recharge 5-6). One creature within 10 ft. must succeed on a DC 13 Dexterity saving throw or lose one small item (a weapon, potion, or trinket), which Lickgloom pulls to itself.



♦ LORE OF ELARIA ♦ The Forest of Whispers

The old grove roads are kept by creatures rather than kingdoms, and the etiquette that holds there is the same one the Long Peace taught: walk through singing, take nothing green, and leave a bite of supper at the trailhead. The kind ones answer kindness, the sky-readers say, which is why the first friend a traveler makes in the Forest of Whispers is so often the truest.

Pikachu, the Spark Fox. *An old friend of the Glimmergear family, bodiless since before the chronicle began, sleeping inside the Essence Sphere. His golden projection first appeared in Gearhaven: two long ears, a lightning-bolt tail, and a warning carried through Ursa's Mark. He has no statistics yet; he is more a key than a creature, and his full return is still to come.*

Session 1: The Forest of Whispers

The first creatures the Guardians ever faced, all touched by the thinning boundary between the planes. Each left behind a fading mote, the party's very first clue.

A duck grown huge and wind-wrapped, roosting in an old rune-carved stone circle; its furious quacks arrive straight in the mind.

DUCKLEAF

Small beast (Elemental Air), neutral ♦ CR 4 (1,100 XP) ♦ guardian of the stone circle

AC 15 (natural armor) **HP** 52 (8d8 + 16) **Speed** 30 ft., fly 30 ft.

STR 14 **DEX** 16 **CON** 14 **INT** 10 **WIS** 12 **CHA** 10

Saves Dex +5, Wis +3 **Skills** Acrobatics +5, Perception +3

Resist slashing, bludgeoning (wind-shielded)

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 13

Languages telepathy 30 ft. (in quacks)

Challenge 4 (1,100 XP)

Traits

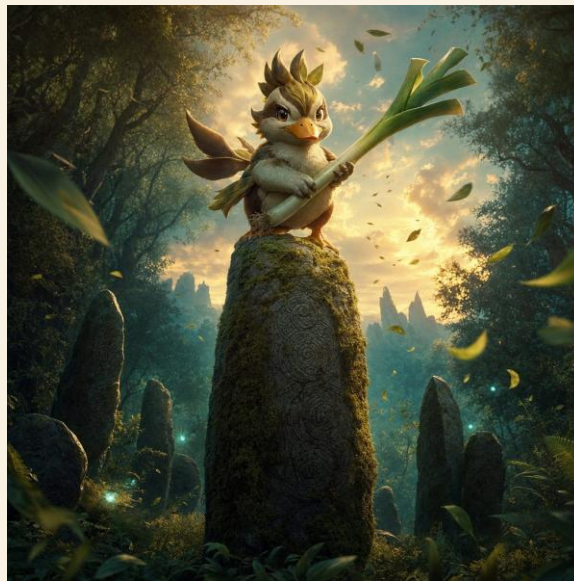
Winged Leap. Duckleaf can leap 30 ft. in any direction without provoking opportunity attacks. Disrupting a stone of the rune-circle ends this ability for the rest of the battle.

Actions

Leek Strike. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 2d8 + 4 slashing.

Aerial Slash. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 3d6 + 3 slashing, a blade of wind.

Quack of Fury (Recharge 5-6). A thunderous telepathic quack. Each creature within 15 ft. makes a DC 14 Wisdom save or is frightened for 1 minute (repeat save at end of each turn).



♦ LORE OF ELARIA ♦ The Rings and Their Keepers

Where a plane leans closest to the world, the old builders raised a ring of stones and asked one creature to keep it: a duck grown huge and wind-wrapped, a fish that swims the open air, a hound woven of mist that hunts the lantern-edge. The keepers were never meant to be fierce, the sky-readers say, only faithful, and a keeper turns dangerous only when the wall it guards begins to fail. Meet one swinging, the Circle teaches, and the kinder question is not how to beat it but what it is so frightened of losing.

A fish that swims through open air above its grove pool, trailing glowing water and speaking in pictures pressed gently into the mind.

COGNIFIN

Small beast (Elemental Water), neutral ◆ CR 3 (700 XP) ◆ the grove's test

AC 14 (natural armor) **HP** 45 (6d8 + 18) **Speed** 0 ft., fly 30 ft. (hover)

STR 10 **DEX** 14 **CON** 16 **INT** 10 **WIS** 14 **CHA** 12

Saves Dex +4, Wis +4 **Skills** Perception +4, Arcana +2

Resist cold, psychic

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages telepathy 60 ft. (images and feelings)

Challenge 3 (700 XP)

Actions

Headache Blast. *Ranged Attack:* +4 to hit, range 30 ft., one target. *Hit:* 2d6 + 2 psychic.

Water Pulse. *Ranged Spell Attack:* +4 to hit, range 30 ft., one target. *Hit:* 2d6 + 2 bludgeoning, and the target must make a DC 12 Strength save or be knocked prone.

Confusion Pulse (Recharge 5-6). A wave of psychic energy in a 15-ft. radius. Each creature there makes a DC 13 Wisdom save or is confused (as the *confusion* spell) for 1 minute (repeat save at end of each turn).

Reactions

Psychic Shield. When hit by an attack, Cognifin gains +2 AC until the start of its next turn.

Legendary Actions

Whirlpool. Cognifin makes a 5-ft.-radius whirlpool; creatures there make a DC 12 Strength save or be pulled 10 ft. to its center and restrained until the end of their next turn.

Tidal Wave. A 10-ft. line of water. Creatures in its path make a DC 12 Dexterity save or take 2d4 bludgeoning and are pushed back 5 ft.



A shape of fog and hunger that hunts at the edge of lantern-light, more shadow than wolf.

MIST STALKER

Medium fey (Feywild), unaligned ◆ CR 2 (450 XP) ◆ they hunt in pairs

AC 13 **HP** 39 (6d8 + 12) **Speed** 40 ft.

STR 14 **DEX** 16 **CON** 14 **INT** 6 **WIS** 12 **CHA** 8

Skills Perception +3, Stealth +5

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 13

Challenge 2 (450 XP)

Traits

Fog Cloak (Bonus Action). The stalker wraps itself in mist, becoming heavily obscured until the start of its next turn.

Actions

Multiattack. The mist stalker makes one bite attack and one claw attack.

Bite. *Melee Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 1d8 + 3 piercing.

Claw. *Melee Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 2d4 + 3 slashing.

Howl of the Mist (Recharge 5-6). A howl rolls through the fog from every direction at once. Each enemy within 30 ft. must succeed on a DC 13 Wisdom saving throw or be frightened until the end of the stalker's next turn.



Session 2: The Road to Ravenstone

On the road to Oakshade and Ravenstone the party met slick water-elementals, an old goblin grudge come calling, and a serpent of living stone.

Slick little elementals of the wayside ponds, harmless-looking right up until the mud starts flying.

MUDSKIP

Small elemental (Plane of Water), neutral ◆ CR 1/2 (100 XP) ◆ mischief in numbers

AC 13 (natural armor) **HP** 22 (4d6 + 8) **Speed** 20 ft., swim 30 ft.

STR 12 **DEX** 14 **CON** 14 **INT** 6 **WIS** 12 **CHA** 8

Skills Stealth +4, Perception +3

Vulnerable lightning **Resist** fire

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 13

Languages understands Aquan but can't speak

Challenge 1/2 (100 XP)

Traits

Amphibious. The Mudskip can breathe air and water.

Mud Dweller. It ignores difficult terrain made of mud or shallow water.

Slippery. Advantage on checks and saves to escape a grapple.

Actions

Multiattack. One Mud Spit and one Tail Slap.

Mud Spit. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, range 30 ft. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) bludgeoning, and on a failed DC 12 Dexterity save the target's speed drops by 10 ft. until end of its next turn.

Tail Slap. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) bludgeoning.

Mud Splash (Recharge 5-6). A 15-ft. cone of mud. DC 12 Dexterity save; 9 (2d6 + 2) bludgeoning and blinded until end of next turn on a fail, half and no blind on a success.



The Grimfang war band. A rival goblin clan carrying an old grudge against Stabby's Bloodfang: two goblin archers, a worg, a club-swinging orc, a hobgoblin sniper, and a scar-faced Goblin Boss who taunted Stabby and regretted it. Driven off, not destroyed; grudges keep. Their statistics are the standard Monster Manual entries.

GOBLIN BOSS (THE GRIMFANG LEADER)

Small humanoid (goblinoid), neutral evil ♦ CR 1 (200 XP) ♦ leads the war band

AC 17 (chain shirt, shield) **HP** 21 (6d6) **Speed** 30 ft.

STR 10 **DEX** 14 **CON** 10 **INT** 10 **WIS** 8 **CHA** 10

Skills Stealth +6

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 9

Languages Common, Goblin

Challenge 1 (200 XP)

Traits

Nimble Escape. The boss can Disengage or Hide as a bonus action on each of its turns.

Actions

Multiattack. Two attacks with its scimitar (the second only if the first hits).

Scimitar. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) slashing.

Javelin. *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 30/120 ft. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing.

Reactions

Redirect Attack. When a creature the boss can see targets it with an attack, it swaps places with a goblin ally within 5 ft.; that ally becomes the target instead.



The band also fielded standard Goblins (AC 15, HP 7), a Worg (AC 13, HP 26), an Orc (AC 13, HP 15), and a Hobgoblin sniper (AC 18, HP 11).

♦ LORE OF ELARIA ♦ The Thorn Clans

Goblins tell it plainly: when the world was woven, some threads stuck out, quick and bright and impossible to trim flat. Those threads became goblins. The briar-maze of Bloodthorn Hollow grew up around the clans, they say, because even the thorns wanted to keep them, and a grudge between two clans can outlast the briar itself.

The serpent of living stone itself: patient as a mountain, and about as easy to push over.

TERRANOX

Large elemental (Plane of Earth), unaligned ♦ CR 4 (1,100 XP) ♦ the boss of Session 2

AC 16 (natural armor) **HP** 95 (10d10 + 40) **Speed** 30 ft., burrow 30 ft.

STR 20 **DEX** 10 **CON** 18 **INT** 5 **WIS** 11 **CHA** 6

Resist bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical, non-adamantine weapons

Imm. fire, poison ♦ (cond) exhaustion, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned, prone

Senses darkvision 60 ft., tremorsense 60 ft., passive Perception 10

Challenge 4 (1,100 XP)

Traits

Earth Glide. Terranox burrows through unworked earth and stone without disturbing it.

Siege Monster. Deals double damage to objects and structures.

Elemental Resilience. Advantage on saves against spells and magical effects.

Immutable Form. Immune to any effect that would alter its form.

Actions

Multiattack. One Bite and one Tail Slam.

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 16 (2d10 + 5) piercing.

Tail Slam. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 15 ft., one target. *Hit:* 13 (2d8 + 5) bludgeoning, and the target must succeed on a DC 15 Strength save or be knocked prone.

Stone Coil (Recharge 5-6). One creature within 10 ft. makes a DC 15 Dexterity save or is grappled and restrained (escape DC 15), taking 9 (1d8 + 5) bludgeoning at the start of each of its turns.

Earthquake Stomp (Recharge 6). A tremor in a 20-ft. radius; each creature on the ground makes a DC 15 Dexterity save, taking 14 (4d6) bludgeoning and knocked prone on a fail (half, no prone, on a success).



♦ LORE OF ELARIA ♦ The Stone Rings

The standing stones scattered across the vales are older than every road. Each ring was raised where a plane leans close to the world, and each was given a guardian, feathered, finned, or worse, to keep the leaning from becoming a fall. When the Darkening thinned the walls, some of those old guardians woke confused and swinging.

Session 3: The Road South

South toward the sea, the party crossed shadowed thickets and glowing fungal groves, and learned that the planar wounds are teaching old monsters new tricks.

A hollow shape of darkness crowned in cold blue flame, hiding among perfect copies of itself.

SHADOWFLAME

Medium undead, chaotic evil ◆ CR 4 (1,100 XP) ◆ fights alone

AC 14 (natural armor) **HP** 58 (9d8 + 18) **Speed** 0 ft., fly 40 ft. (hover)

STR 8 **DEX** 18 **CON** 14 **INT** 12 **WIS** 15 **CHA** 18

Skills Stealth +8, Intimidation +6

Resist acid, fire, lightning, necrotic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical weapons

Imm. poison, psychic ◆ (cond) charmed, frightened, grappled, paralyzed, poisoned, prone, restrained

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 12

Languages understands Common, Sylvan, and Abyssal (does not speak)

Challenge 4 (1,100 XP)

Traits

Illusions of Fear. At the start of combat, the Shadowflame conjures three identical illusions (AC 14). A creature attacking one must succeed on a DC 18 Arcana or Perception check to know it is false; on a failure the attack misses and the illusion remains.

Actions

Shadow Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 13 (2d8 + 4) necrotic, and the target must succeed on a DC 14 Wisdom save or be frightened until end of next turn.

Terror Wave (Recharge 5-6). A 15-ft. cone of dark energy. Each creature makes a DC 14 Wisdom save, taking 16 (3d10) necrotic and frightened for 1 minute on a fail (repeat save at end of each turn).

Reactions

Shadowmeld. When hit, the Shadowflame teleports up to 20 ft. to an unoccupied space it can see, becoming lightly obscured until the start of its next turn.



Displacer Beasts (a pair). *Six-legged, tentacled, and impossibly TALKING ('Fresh prey... too easy.')*: the planar distortion had given old monsters new voices. Their shimmering forms impose disadvantage on attacks against them until they take damage; their barbed tentacles strike at 10 ft. Their fall revealed rune-tears in the forest floor. (Statistics as the standard Displacer Beast, CR 3, AC 13, HP 85.)

A guardian of the glowing fungal groves, all soft lantern-light and stubborn spores.

SHROOMYTE

Small plant, neutral ♦ CR 2 (450 XP) ♦ they defend the grove in fours

AC 13 (natural armor) **HP** 27 (5d8 + 5) **Speed** 20 ft.

STR 12 **DEX** 12 **CON** 14 **INT** 6 **WIS** 12 **CHA** 7

Saves Con +4, Wis +3 **Skills** Stealth +3, Perception +3

Resist poison **Imm.** (cond) poisoned

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 13

Languages understands Sylvan but can't speak

Challenge 2 (450 XP)

Traits

Bioluminescent Glow. The Shroomyte sheds dim light in a 10-ft. radius, which it can suppress or rekindle as a bonus action.

Fungal Resilience. Advantage on saves against being charmed, frightened, or stunned.

Actions

Multiattack. One Spore Blast and one Mycelium Tendrils.

Spore Blast. *Ranged Spell Attack:* +4 to hit, range 30 ft. *Hit:* 9 (2d6 + 2) poison, and the target must succeed on a DC 13 Constitution save or be poisoned until end of its next turn.

Mycelium Tendrils. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 10 ft. *Hit:* 7 (2d4 + 2) bludgeoning, and a DC 13 Strength save or restrained until end of its next turn.

Reactions

Fungal Retribution. When a creature within 5 ft. hits it in melee, the Shroomyte bursts spores; the attacker makes a DC 13 Constitution save or takes 5 (2d4) poison.



♦ LORE OF ELARIA ♦ The Glowing Groves

South of the vale the forest thins and the light begins to come up out of the ground instead of down through the leaves. Whole hillsides of luminous fungus keep a slow green daylight there, and the Shroomytes tend it the way shepherds tend a flock, kindling and hooding their own glow to signal one another across the dark. Travelers of the Long Peace learned the grove's single rule quickly: the light is not yours to carry off, only to walk by, and a grove left unspoiled will light you the whole way to the coast. Trample it, the old warning ends, and the spores remember longer than you will.

Session 4: The Longest Night of Havenmoor

A whole winter court had risen with the Krampusshade. These are the dangers that stalked the frozen roads of Havenmoor, and the fiend that ruled them.

The fiend of the longest night itself: horned, chain-draped, and smiling, striding the snows with a sack of cursed gifts over one shoulder.

THE KRAMPUSSHADE

Large fiend, chaotic evil ◆ CR 5 (1,800 XP) ◆ the boss of Session 4

AC 15 (natural armor) **HP** 102 (12d10 + 36) **Speed** 40 ft.

STR 18 **DEX** 14 **CON** 16 **INT** 12 **WIS** 14 **CHA** 17

Saves Wis +5, Cha +6

Resist cold, necrotic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Imm. poison ◆ (cond) charmed, frightened, poisoned

Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages Abyssal, Common, Infernal

Challenge 5 (1,800 XP)

Actions

Multiattack. One Claw and one Chains of Despair.

Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 12 (2d6 + 4) slashing plus 5 (1d10) cold.

Chains of Despair. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 15 ft., one target. *Hit:* 11 (2d6 + 4) bludgeoning, and a DC 14 Strength save or restrained until end of its next turn.

Gift of Despair (Recharge 5-6). It hurls a cursed gift box at a target within 30 ft.; DC 14 Wisdom save or frightened for 1 minute (repeat save at end of each turn).

Reactions

Icy Retaliation. When hit by a melee attack, the attacker makes a DC 14 Constitution save or takes 7 (2d6) cold and has its speed reduced by 10 ft. until end of its next turn.

Legendary Actions

Shadow Step. The Krampusshade teleports up to 20 ft. to an unoccupied space in dim light or darkness. (Rung together, the eight Winter Bells strip away its power.)



A red-eyed sliver of shadow that giggles in the dark between the lantern posts.

Sneak-thieves of the winter court: shadowy imps with glowing red eyes and jagged claws, leaping from cover to steal whatever shone brightest in a hero's pack.

And the gift-box mimics were the season's cruelest joke: presents that bit back, and stuck fast to any hand that reached for them.

KRAMPUS'S IMP

Small fiend (shadow), chaotic evil ♦ CR 2 (450 XP)



AC 14 (natural armor) **HP** 22 (5d6 + 5)
Speed 30 ft., fly 40 ft.
STR 10 **DEX** 16 **CON** 12 **INT** 13 **WIS** 11 **CHA** 14
Skills Stealth +6, Deception +4
Resist cold, fire, necrotic; nonmagical B/P/S
Imm. poison ♦ (cond) poisoned
Senses darkvision 120 ft.
Languages Infernal, Common
Challenge 2 (450 XP)

Traits

Shadow Stealth. Can Hide as a bonus action in dim light or darkness.

Invisibility (3/short rest). Turns invisible as a bonus action until it attacks or casts a spell.

Magic Resistance. Advantage on saves against spells and magical effects.

Shadow Glide. Can move through creatures' spaces in dim light or darkness.

Actions

Shadow Claws. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 8 (2d4 + 3) slashing plus 3 (1d6) cold.

Shadowy Grasp (Recharge 5-6). A target makes a DC 13 Dexterity save or is restrained until end of the imp's next turn, taking 5 (1d10) cold at the start of each of its turns while restrained.

KRAMPUSSHADE MINION

Small fiend, chaotic evil ♦ CR 2 (450 XP)



AC 15 (natural armor) **HP** 33 (6d6 + 12)
Speed 40 ft., fly 30 ft.
Skills Stealth +6, Sleight of Hand +6
Resist cold, necrotic; nonmagical B/P/S
Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 12
Languages Common, Infernal
Challenge 2 (450 XP)

Actions

Shadow Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 9 (2d4 + 4) slashing, and the target must succeed on a DC 13 Wisdom save or be frightened until the end of its next turn.

Steal Object. The minion tries to snatch a small item; the target must succeed on a DC 14 Dexterity save or lose the item.

MIMIC (GIFT BOX)

Medium monstrosity (shapechanger), neutral ♦ CR 2 (450 XP)



AC 12 (natural armor) **HP** 58 (9d8 + 18)
Speed 15 ft.
Skills Stealth +5
Imm. acid ♦ (cond) prone
Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 11
Languages none
Challenge 2 (450 XP)

Traits

Shapechanger. The mimic can use its action to polymorph into an object (a wrapped gift box, most often) or back into its true, toothy form.

Actions

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d8 + 3) piercing plus 4 (1d8) acid.

Adhesive. The mimic adheres to anything that touches it; a creature grappled by the mimic must succeed on a DC 13 Strength check to escape.

Winter-touched wolves with frost-blue eyes, running the drifts in hungry packs.

A wicked little wisp of a fey, all giggles and ice needles.

And a mournful spirit of the deep cold that drifts through walls and wails away courage.

FROZEN WOLF

Medium beast, neutral evil ♦ pack hunters



AC 15 (natural armor) **HP** 45 (6d10 + 12)
Speed 40 ft.
STR 16 **DEX** 15 **CON** 14 **INT** 3 **WIS** 12
CHA 6

Imm. cold

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages understands Sylvan but cannot speak

Traits

Pack Tactics. Advantage on attacks against a creature if an ally is within 5 ft. of it and not incapacitated.

Icy Terrain. The ground within 10 ft. of the wolf is difficult terrain for other creatures.

Actions

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 12 (2d6 + 3) piercing plus 4 (1d8) cold, and a DC 13 Constitution save or speed reduced by 10 ft. until end of its next turn.

Frost Breath (Recharge 5-6). A 15-ft. cone of icy air. Each creature makes a DC 13 Dexterity save, taking 18 (4d8) cold on a fail (half on a success); those who fail are slowed until end of next turn.

FROSTBITE PIXIE

Tiny Fey, chaotic neutral ♦ CR 1/4 (50 XP)



AC 15 **HP** 14 (4d4 + 4)
Speed 20 ft., fly 60 ft.
STR 3 **DEX** 20 **CON** 12 **INT** 14 **WIS** 11
CHA 16

Skills Stealth +7

Imm. cold

Languages Sylvan, Common

Challenge 1/4 (50 XP)

Actions

Ray of Frost. *Ranged Spell Attack:* +5 to hit, range 60 ft. *Hit:* 7 (2d8) cold, and the target's speed is reduced by 10 ft. until end of its next turn.

Invisibility. The pixie turns invisible until it attacks or casts a spell.

ICY SPECTER

Medium undead, neutral evil ♦ drifts through walls



AC 12 **HP** 45 (10d8)
Speed 0 ft., fly 50 ft. (hover)
STR 1 **DEX** 14 **CON** 11 **INT** 10 **WIS** 10
CHA 16

Resist cold, necrotic; nonmagical B/P/S

Imm. poison ♦ (cond) charmed, exhaustion, grappled, paralyzed, poisoned, prone, restrained

Actions

Chilling Touch. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 10 (3d6) cold.

Wail of Despair (Recharge 5-6). Each creature within 30 ft. makes a DC 14 Wisdom save or is frightened for 1 minute (repeat save at end of each turn).

The great black cat of midwinter tales, silent on the snow and quick to pounce; and she who waits by the roadside with warm pastries and a warmer smile, neither of which is what it seems.

YULE CAT

Large fey beast, neutral ♦ CR 3 (700 XP) ♦ prowls alone



AC 15 (natural armor) **HP** 52 (7d10 + 14)
Speed 40 ft., climb 30 ft.
STR 18 **DEX** 16 **CON** 14 **INT** 6 **WIS** 14 **CHA** 10
Skills Perception +4, Stealth +6 **Resist** cold
Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14
Challenge 3 (700 XP)

Actions

Frost Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 10 (2d6 + 3) slashing plus 3 (1d6) cold.

Frostbite Pounce. If the Yule Cat moves 20 ft. and hits with Frost Claw, the target makes a DC 14 Strength save or is knocked prone; if prone, the cat makes another Frost Claw as a bonus action.

Chilling Gaze (Recharge 5-6). One target within 30 ft. makes a DC 14 Constitution save or takes 9 (2d8) cold and is paralyzed until end of its next turn.

FROST HAG (DISGUISED)

Medium fey, neutral evil ♦ CR 4 (1,100 XP) ♦ alone at her cauldron



AC 15 **HP** 52
Speed 30 ft.
STR 14 **DEX** 14 **CON** 14 **INT** 13 **WIS** 12 **CHA** 14
Challenge 4 (1,100 XP)

Traits

Kindly Guise. The hag appears as a sweet old woman offering sugared pastries; those who eat them make a DC 13 Constitution save or are poisoned for 1 hour, taking 1d4 cold.

Actions

Icy Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 10 (2d6 + 3) slashing plus 4 (1d6) cold.

Frostbite Breath (Recharge 5-6). A 15-ft. cone; DC 14 Constitution save, 16 (4d6) cold (half on a success); on a fail the target is slowed until its next turn.

Misty Step (Bonus Action). The hag teleports 30 ft.

Walking snowdrifts with hearts of blue ice; top-hatted snowmen gone slightly wrong; crystal-bodied spiders whose webs glitter like spun frost; and cold lights that bob invitingly over the snow, luring travelers off the safe path.

ENCHANTED SNOWMAN

Small construct, unaligned ♦ CR 1 (200 XP)



AC 13 **HP** 30 (4d8 + 12)
Speed 20 ft.
STR 12 **DEX** 10 **CON** 16 **INT** 3 **WIS** 10 **CHA** 6
Challenge 1 (200 XP)

Actions

Frostball. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit. *Hit:* 2d4 cold, and a DC 12 Constitution save or speed halved until end of its next turn.

ICE SPIDER

Medium beast, unaligned ♦ CR 1 (200 XP)



AC 14 (natural armor) **HP** 26 (4d10 + 4)
Speed 30 ft., climb 30 ft.
STR 12 **DEX** 14 **CON** 12 **INT** 2 **WIS** 11 **CHA** 4
Challenge 1 (200 XP)

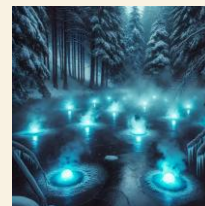
Actions

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 9 (1d8 + 1) piercing plus 4 (1d6) cold, and a DC 13 Constitution save or poisoned for 1 minute.

Web (Recharge 5-6). *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, range 30 ft. On a hit the target is restrained by webbing (DC 13 Strength to escape).

FROZEN WILL-O'-WISP

Tiny undead, chaotic evil ♦ CR 2 (450 XP)



AC 15 **HP** 22 (5d8)
Speed 0 ft., fly 50 ft. (hover)
STR 1 **DEX** 18 **CON** 10 **INT** 10 **WIS** 12 **CHA** 11
Resist cold, lightning; nonmagical B/P/S
Imm. poison ♦ (cond) exhaustion, grappled, paralyzed, prone
Challenge 2 (450 XP)

Actions

Icy Shock. *Melee Spell Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 9 (2d8) lightning plus 4 (1d6) cold.

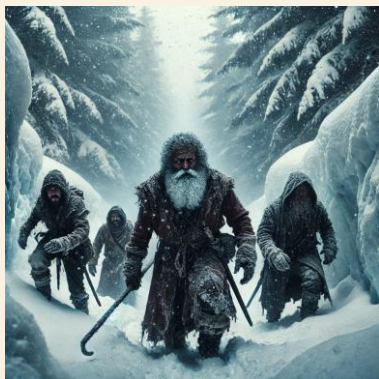
Invisibility. The wisp turns invisible until it attacks.

Kinder meetings walked the same roads: a resting reindeer whose glowing nose blessed kind travelers, a friendly caribou that healed the weary, and Aurora Spirits, gentle messengers of Elaria who traded a prophecy for a moment's respect. None of these gentle ones has statistics; they were never for fighting.

Not villains so much as frozen, starving folk; a warm meal has ended more of these fights than any sword. The frost golems that rise beside them argue less.

SNOWBOUND BANDIT LEADER

Medium humanoid, neutral ♦ leads a desperate band



AC 14 HP 32
Speed 30 ft.
STR 14 DEX 13 CON 12 INT 10 WIS 11 CHA 11

Traits

Desperate, Not Cruel. Driven mad by the cold; kindness (food, warmth) or a DC 14 Intimidation check can end the fight before it begins.

Actions

Scimitar. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 7 (1d6 + 3) slashing.

Dagger. *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit. *Hit:* 5 (1d4 + 3) piercing.

Frostbite Strike (Recharge 5-6). +5 to hit; an extra 1d6 cold, and a DC 13 Constitution save or speed reduced by 10 ft. until its next turn.

SNOWBOUND BANDIT

Medium humanoid, neutral ♦ the rank and file



AC 12 HP 20
Speed 30 ft.

Traits

Desperate, Not Cruel. Like their leader, the bandits fight out of hunger and cold; kindness can end the fight before it begins.

Actions

Scimitar. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) slashing.

Shortbow. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing.

FROST GOLEM

Medium elemental, neutral ♦ CR 2 (450 XP)



AC 14 (natural armor) HP 42 (5d10 + 15)
Speed 20 ft.

STR 16 DEX 10 CON 16 INT 6 WIS 10 CHA 5

Resist cold; nonmagical B/P/S

Imm. (cond) exhaustion, poisoned
Challenge 2 (450 XP)

Traits

Frost Aura. At the start of each creature's turn within 5 ft. of the golem, that creature takes 2 cold.

Actions

Icy Slam. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 7 (2d6 + 3) bludgeoning plus 3 (1d4) cold.

♦ LORE OF ELARIA ♦ The Longest Night

The Circle marks one night a year when the dark leans hardest on the world, and teaches that it is not to be feared but outlasted. Kindle a light, share a warm meal, ring a true bell, and keep one another company until dawn, the old rule runs, for the longest night has never once failed to end, and the things that walk it are hungriest for the lonely.

Session 5: The Flying Dutchman

Aboard the ghost-ship of Davy Jones the party fought a drowned crew of smugglers and spirits, all of them (like the Captain) undone by cold and by the sea taking back its own.

The Captain himself: barnacle-armed, tentacle-bearded, master of the Dutchman and keeper of the souls that serve aboard her.

DAVY JONES, CAPTAIN OF THE FLYING DUTCHMAN

Medium undead (formerly humanoid), chaotic evil ◆ CR 6 (2,300 XP) ◆ the boss of Session 5

AC 17 (barnacle armor) **HP** 85 (10d10 + 30) **Speed** 30 ft., swim 30 ft.

STR 18 **DEX** 12 **CON** 16 **INT** 14 **WIS** 12 **CHA** 16

Saves Con +6, Wis +4, Cha +6

Skills Intimidation +6, Perception +4, Athletics +7, Survival +4

Resist bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Imm. (cond) charmed, frightened, poisoned, exhaustion

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages Common, Aquan

Challenge 6 (2,300 XP)

Traits

Barnacle Armor. Nonmagical melee attacks against him deal half damage.

Legendary Resistance (3/Day). If Davy fails a save, he can choose to succeed instead.

Amphibious. He can breathe air and water.

Actions

Multiattack. Two Tentacle Slams and one Hook Strike.

Tentacle Slam. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 10 ft. *Hit:* 10 (2d6 + 4) bludgeoning, and the target is grappled (escape DC 15).

Hook Strike. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 8 (1d6 + 4) piercing plus 7 (2d6) necrotic.

Soul Siphon (Recharge 5-6). One creature makes a DC 14 Constitution save or takes 18 (4d8) psychic; Davy heals half the damage dealt.

Legendary Actions

Tentacle Strike. Davy makes one Tentacle Slam.

Raise Tide (2 actions). A 20-ft. line; DC 14 Dexterity save or 13 (3d8) bludgeoning.



The rank and file of the drowned crew, still following orders long past their last breath; and a ghost still at its post at the wheel, pale scimitars of force in both hands.

DROWNED PIRATE

Medium undead, chaotic evil ♦ CR 1 (200 XP) ♦ the deck crew



AC 14 (studded leather or chain shirt) **HP** 58 (9d8 + 18)

Speed 30 ft., swim 30 ft.

STR 18 **DEX** 14 **CON** 14 **INT** 6 **WIS** 10 **CHA** 7

Saves Wis +2 **Skills** Perception +2

Resist nonmagical B/P/S

Imm. poison ♦ (cond) charmed, exhaustion, frightened, paralyzed, poisoned

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 12

Languages understands Common but can't speak

Challenge 1 (200 XP)

Traits

Amphibious. The pirate can breathe air and water.

Undead Fortitude. If reduced to 0 HP (not by radiant or a crit), a DC 5 + damage Constitution save drops it to 1 HP instead.

Actions

Multiattack. Two melee attacks.

Cutlass. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 8 (1d8 + 4) slashing.

Harpoon. *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 10 ft. or range 30/120 ft. *Hit:* 9 (1d10 + 4) piercing, and the target is grappled (escape DC 14).

Reactions

Death Burst. When the pirate dies it bursts; each creature within 5 ft. makes a DC 12 Constitution save or takes 5 (2d4) cold and gains one level of exhaustion.

SPECTRAL HELMSMAN

Medium undead, chaotic evil ♦ CR 1 (200 XP) ♦ still at the wheel



AC 12 **HP** 45 (6d8 + 18)

Speed 0 ft., fly 50 ft. (hover)

STR 6 **DEX** 14 **CON** 16 **INT** 10 **WIS** 12 **CHA** 11

Saves Wis +3, Cha +2 **Skills** Perception +3, Stealth +4

Resist acid, fire, lightning, thunder; nonmagical B/P/S

Imm. cold, necrotic, poison ♦ (cond) charmed, exhaustion, grappled, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned, prone, restrained

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 13

Languages understands Common but can't speak

Challenge 1 (200 XP)

Traits

Incorporeal Movement. Can move through creatures and objects as difficult terrain.

Sea-Wraith Aura. At the start of each of its turns, creatures within 5 ft. make a DC 12 Wisdom save or are frightened until their next turn.

Actions

Multiattack. Two Spectral Scimitar attacks.

Spectral Scimitar. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 7 (1d6 + 4) force.

Harpoon Throw. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, range 20/60 ft. *Hit:* 9 (1d10 + 4) piercing and the target is pulled up to 10 ft.

Reactions

Phantom Helm Block. When attacked, it imposes disadvantage on one weapon attack roll.

Deeper in the ship waited the hold guard: a hulking crate-stacker built to guard cargo and happy to crush anything else, duelists with sorcery stitched into their sabers, and a flickering lantern-spirit of the rigging, nearly impossible to see and harder to catch.

SMUGGLER'S GOLEM

Large construct, unaligned ♦ CR 2 (450 XP)



AC 14 (natural armor) **HP** 85 (10d10 + 30)
Speed 30 ft.
STR 19 **DEX** 9 **CON** 16 **INT** 3 **WIS** 10 **CHA** 5
Vulnerable cold
Resist fire, lightning, acid
Imm. poison, psychic; nonmagical B/P/S
 ♦ (cond) charmed, exhaustion, frightened, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned, prone
Senses darkvision 60 ft., tremorsense 30 ft., passive Perception 10
Languages understands its creator's commands
Challenge 2 (450 XP)

Traits

Immutable Form. Immune to effects that would alter its form.
Magic Resistance. Advantage on saves against spells.
Siege Monster. Deals double damage to objects.

Actions

Multiattack. Two Slam attacks.
Slam. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 10 ft. *Hit:* 2d8 + 5 bludgeoning.
Crush Crate (Recharge 5-6). One object or creature takes 6d6 (DC 15 Dexterity save for half); a creature that fails is knocked prone.

Reactions

Reinforced Hide. +2 AC against one melee attack.

ARCANE CORSAIR

Medium humanoid, chaotic neutral ♦ CR 1 (200 XP)



AC 14 (studded leather) **HP** 52 (7d8 + 21)
Speed 30 ft.
STR 16 **DEX** 16 **CON** 16 **INT** 12 **WIS** 11 **CHA** 14
Vulnerable cold **Saves** Dex +5, Cha +4
Skills Acrobatics +5, Perception +2
Resist fire, lightning
Imm. (cond) frightened
Languages Common, Thieves' Cant
Challenge 1 (200 XP)

Traits

Sneak Attack (1/turn). +2d6 damage when it has advantage or an ally is adjacent to the target.
Parry. +2 AC against one melee attack.

Actions

Multiattack. Two Arcane Saber attacks.
Arcane Saber. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit. *Hit:* 1d8 + 3 slashing plus 1d6 force.
Riposte (Recharge 5-6). A reaction attack after an enemy misses it in melee.

Reactions

Evasive Step. It Disengages, moving without provoking opportunity attacks.

GHOST-LIGHT ENGINEER

Tiny undead, neutral evil ♦ CR 2 (450 XP)



AC 15 (natural armor) **HP** 27 (6d4 + 12)
Speed 0 ft., fly 50 ft. (hover)
STR 1 **DEX** 18 **CON** 14 **INT** 12 **WIS** 14 **CHA** 16
Vulnerable cold **Saves** Wis +4, Cha +5
Skills Arcana +3, Perception +4, Stealth +8
Resist acid, fire, lightning, thunder; nonmagical B/P/S
Imm. necrotic, poison, psychic ♦ (cond) charmed, exhaustion, frightened, grappled, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned, prone, restrained
Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14
Languages Common, its creator's languages
Challenge 2 (450 XP)

Traits

Invisibility (Recharge 4-6). Turns invisible until it attacks, casts, or its concentration ends.
Glowing Core. A faint glow is visible within 5 ft. even while invisible.

Actions

Shock Touch. *Melee Spell Attack:* +6 to hit. *Hit:* 2d6 + 2 lightning.
Arcane Pulse (Recharge 5-6). A 10-ft. cone; DC 13 Dexterity save, 4d6 force (half on a success).

Reactions

Engineered Reflexes. Halves the damage from one attack or harmful spell.

Session 6: The False Hydra of Wraithpine

The worst monster the Guardians ever faced, because no one knew it was there. Beneath the Old Theater of Wraithpine, its endless song made the whole village forget the people it took. Beeswax in the ears let the truth through.

The first glimpse of the horror: a single pale head and neck rising through the tavern trapdoor, singing all the while.

Each head is pale, blind-eyed, and always singing, even as it bites.

FALSE HYDRA: TAVERN HEAD

Large aberration (one head and neck), unaligned ♦ it has been in the taproom all along



AC 14 **HP** 70 (9d10 + 18) **Speed** 10 ft., climb 10 ft.
STR 16 **DEX** 12 **CON** 14 **INT** 6 **WIS** 14 **CHA** 7
Resist psychic **Imm.** (cond) charmed, frightened, prone
Senses blindsight 10 ft., tremorsense 30 ft., darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14

Traits

Mind-Humming Aura. Creatures without beeswax that start their turn within 30 ft. make a DC 13 Wisdom save or have disadvantage on attack rolls that turn. Beeswax grants advantage on the save.

Segmented Neck. The head ignores forced movement and prone unless it chooses otherwise. When it takes 20+ damage in a turn, it recoils 5 ft. (no opportunity attacks) and can't take reactions until the start of its next turn.

Actions

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 10 ft. *Hit:* 13 (2d8 + 4) piercing, and the target is grappled (escape DC 14). While grappling it can't bite a different target.

Lurch & Drag. A grappled target is dragged 5 ft. toward the trapdoor and, on a failed DC 13 Wisdom save, loses a word or thought for a heartbeat.

Reactions

Recoil from Flame. When it takes fire damage, it has disadvantage on its next attack.

FALSE HYDRA HEAD (X4)

Large aberration (an extension of the body), unaligned ♦ four in the pit



AC 14 **HP** 45 (6d10 + 12) each **Speed** 30 ft. (platforms, tunnels), climb 20 ft.

STR 16 **DEX** 12 **CON** 14 **INT** 6 **WIS** 14 **CHA** 7

Saves Wis +4

Resist psychic **Imm.** (cond) charmed, frightened, prone

Actions

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 15 ft. *Hit:* 14 (2d10 + 3) piercing and grappled (escape DC 14). While grappling it can't bite a different target.

Reel. A creature grappled by the head makes a DC 14 Strength save or is pulled 10 ft. toward the port and knocked prone.

Reactions

Snap. When a creature moves within 15 ft., the head makes one Bite against it.

Deeper still, in the drowned orchestra pit, waited the true body and its four heads, all singing as one. The moment the song stopped, every stolen name came flooding home.

FALSE HYDRA (ADULT): BODY

Huge aberration, unaligned ♦ the boss of Session 6

AC 15 **HP** 130 (12d12 + 48) **Speed** 10 ft., climb 10 ft.

STR 18 **DEX** 10 **CON** 18 **INT** 7 **WIS** 14 **CHA** 8

Saves Con +8, Wis +5

Resist psychic **Imm.** (cond) charmed, frightened, prone

Senses tremorsense 60 ft., darkvision 60 ft., blindsight 10 ft., passive Perception 12

Traits

Song of Unremembering. While any head lives, creatures without earplugs that start their turn within 60 ft. make a DC 15 Wisdom save or have disadvantage on attacks and can't take reactions until their next turn. Beeswax grants advantage and no reaction-lock.

Many-Minds. For each head alive, the body has 1 Legendary Action (max 3 per round).

Vital Link. While at least one head lives, the body has resistance to all weapon damage; each head destroyed removes one instance of this protection.

Actions

Thrash. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 10 ft. *Hit:* 13 (2d8 + 4) bludgeoning.

Regurgitate Remnants (Recharge 5-6). A 15-ft. cone of bone and cloth; DC 14 Dexterity save, 13 (3d8) necrotic and slowed (speed -10) until end of next turn. A shattered skull and ribbon clatter free.

Legendary Actions

Hum Surge. One creature within 60 ft. (no earplugs) makes a DC 15 Wisdom save or loses concentration and can move only 10 ft. on its next turn.

Bone Shift. Move the body 5 ft. and reshape a 10-ft. square within 20 ft. into (or out of) difficult terrain.

Coordinate Strike. One head makes a Snap.



♦ LORE OF ELARIA ♦ Where the Silence Pools

In the deepest drowned places, the flooded warrens and the sunken halls, silence gathers the way cold water gathers at the bottom of a well. Something learned long ago to live in that silence and to feed on the memory of itself, so that the ones it takes are not mourned but only, quietly, forgotten. The Circle's warning for such places is the oldest kind: count your companions by name, out loud, and if the count will not come right, do not go deeper. Sing instead, for the one thing the silence has never been able to swallow is a song freely shared.

Festival frights. Before the theater, the hydra's hungry song had stirred lesser echoes all over Wraithpine: animated Scarecrows and rustling Strawlings on Pumpkin Row, rats and rat swarms in Maera's cellar, and restless Zombies (and, if things went loud, Skeletons) at the graveyard rite.

ANIMATED SCARECROW

Medium construct, neutral ◆ CR 1 (200 XP) ◆ Pumpkin Row



AC 11 **HP** 36 (8d8) **Speed** 30 ft.
STR 16 **DEX** 12 **CON** 11 **INT** 10 **WIS** 10 **CHA** 10
Vulnerable fire
Resist nonmagical B/P/S
Imm. (cond) charmed, frightened, paralyzed, poisoned
Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 10
Languages understands its creator's languages but can't speak
Challenge 1 (200 XP)

Traits

Terrifying Glare. One creature within 30 ft. must succeed on a DC 11 Wisdom save or be frightened for 1 minute (repeat save at end of each turn).

Heart-Gourd. A coin-sized gourd charm is sewn under its ribs; snipping it (an action within 5 ft., no roll) makes the scarecrow fall limp.

Actions

Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* two claws, +5 to hit, reach 5 ft.
Hit: 6 (2d4 + 1) slashing.

STRAWLING

Medium plant, neutral ◆ CR 1/4 (50 XP) ◆ more startling than deadly



AC 12 **HP** 11 (2d8 + 2) **Speed** 30 ft.
STR 12 **DEX** 12 **CON** 12 **INT** 4 **WIS** 10 **CHA** 3
Senses passive Perception 10
Challenge 1/4 (50 XP)

Actions

Needles. *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* a bristle of straw-needles; easily bowled over by a hay cart or a kicked pumpkin stack.

The cellar vermin were ordinary Rats (AC 12, HP 7, CR 1/8) and a Swarm of Rats (AC 10, HP 24, CR 1/4). The graveyard undead were standard Zombies (AC 8, HP 22, CR 1/4; Undead Fortitude) and, only if the rite went loud, Skeletons (AC 13, HP 13, CR 1/4).

Session 7: Gearhaven, the Clockwork City

In the clockwork city, the enemy was no monster at all but corruption bleeding up through the cracks, reaching INTO the machines the people loved. Note the rotation: the lightning eaters and the fire eaters trade off. Freed, not killed: these were innocents.

Cogtooth Market's little brass helpers gone haywire, sparks snapping from every joint; and a dockside lifter the size of a shed, swinging its forklift arms like siege weapons.

ROGUE SERVITOR

Small construct, unaligned ♦ CR 2 ♦ freed, not killed



AC 15 **HP** 39 (6d6 + 18) **Speed** 30 ft.
STR 13 **DEX** 16 **CON** 16 **INT** 3 **WIS** 8 **CHA** 5
Resist poison; nonmagical B/P/S
Imm. (cond) charmed, frightened, poisoned, exhaustion
Senses darkvision 60 ft.
Challenge 2

Traits

Overclocked Death-Spark. At 0 HP, each creature within 10 ft. makes a DC 13 Dexterity save or takes 7 (2d6) lightning.

Shutdown Switch. An action within 5 ft. plus a DC 14 Arcana or Sleight of Hand check shuts it down instantly, no kill needed.

Actions

Multiattack. Two Flailing Slams.

Flailing Slam. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 8 (1d10 + 3) bludgeoning.

Spark Lash (Recharge 5-6). *Ranged Attack:* +5 to hit, range 30 ft. *Hit:* 10 (3d6) lightning; the target's speed is halved until end of its next turn.

CARGO HAULER

Large construct, unaligned ♦ CR 3 ♦ the dockside lifter



AC 16 **HP** 76 (8d10 + 32) **Speed** 30 ft.
STR 19 **DEX** 8 **CON** 18 **INT** 3 **WIS** 8 **CHA** 5
Vulnerable lightning (overloaded core; telegraph the crackling blue!)

Resist nonmagical B/P/S

Imm. (cond) charmed, exhaustion, frightened, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned

Challenge 3

Traits

Out-of-Reach Switch. Its shutdown lever is 15 ft. up on its back; reaching it (climb DC 13 or flight) plus an action and a DC 15 Arcana or Sleight of Hand check disables it.

Actions

Multiattack. Two Forklift Slams, or one Slam and one Hurl Crate.

Forklift Slam. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 10 ft. *Hit:* 13 (2d8 + 4) bludgeoning, and a DC 14 Strength save or knocked prone.

Hurl Crate. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, range 60 ft. *Hit:* 14 (3d6 + 4) bludgeoning.

Grab & Crush (Recharge 5-6). One creature within 10 ft. makes a DC 14 Dexterity save or is grappled (escape DC 14), taking 10 (3d6) at the start of each of its turns until it escapes.

Spark-yellow skitterers of the Underworks, flickering in and out of the Real; and the nest-queen of the swarm, spinning webs of living lightning.

VOLTCRAWLER

Small aberration (planar intruder), unaligned ♦ the swarm



AC 15 **HP** 22 (5d6 + 5) **Speed** 30 ft., climb 30 ft.
STR 7 **DEX** 17 **CON** 13 **INT** 5 **WIS** 10 **CHA** 6
Resist lightning
Senses darkvision 60 ft.

Traits

Phase-Blink. At the start of its turn, roll a d6: on a 1-2 it goes Unreal, resisting all damage except force and radiant, and attacks against it have disadvantage; it can't be webbed or grappled and must become Real to attack. (Force and radiant are the counter.)

Static Cling. The first time it hits a creature each turn, that target's lightning resistance is ignored and its allies have advantage on their next attack against it.

Actions

Spark Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 1d6 + 3 piercing plus 1d6 lightning.

Arc (Recharge 5-6). A 15-ft. line; DC 13 Dexterity save, 2d8 lightning (half on a success). Two or more Voltcrawlers within 15 ft. can chain into one 3d8 line.

VOLTCRAWLER BROODMOTHER

Medium aberration (planar intruder), unaligned ♦ the nest-queen



AC 16 **HP** 95 (10d8 + 50) **Speed** 40 ft., climb 40 ft.
STR 14 **DEX** 18 **CON** 20 **INT** 6 **WIS** 12 **CHA** 8
Saves Dex +7, Con +8
Resist lightning; nonmagical B/P/S
Senses darkvision 60 ft.

Traits

Phase-Blink (greater). She chooses to go Unreal as a free action once per round (no roll).

Crackling Web. At the start of her turn, one creature she sees within 30 ft. makes a DC 15 Dexterity save or is restrained by planar silk (action plus DC 15 Strength to break; web AC 12, 15 HP, immune lightning, VULNERABLE fire and cold).

Actions

Multiattack. Two Lash attacks.

Lash. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 10 ft. *Hit:* 1d10 + 4 slashing plus 1d8 lightning.

Overcharge (Recharge 6). A 20-ft.-radius burst; DC 15 Constitution save, 4d8 lightning (half on a success). On a fail the target also can't take reactions until end of its next turn.

Worker-machines with corrupted vine knotted through their gears: slow, sad, and unstoppable. Around their feet, fist-sized knots of corrupted vine keep coming as long as the engine feeds them.

IRON DRUDGE

Large construct (planar-corrupted), unaligned ♦ CR 3 ♦ freed, not killed



AC 17 **HP** 68 (8d10 + 24) **Speed** 25 ft.

STR 19 **DEX** 8 **CON** 17 **INT** 3 **WIS** 8 **CHA** 1

Vulnerable fire (corrupted wood and vine in its joints; telegraph the smoke!)

Resist nonmagical B/P/S

Imm. (cond) charmed, frightened, exhaustion, poisoned

Senses darkvision 60 ft.

Challenge 3

Traits

Slow but Unstoppable. Can't be knocked prone; ignores difficult terrain. It is slow enough to outrun, but it keeps coming.

Corruption Leak. At 0 HP the blue light gutters out and it slumps, harmless. No death-burst: these were innocent worker-machines, freed rather than destroyed.

Actions

Multiattack. Two Cargo-Arm Slams.

Cargo-Arm Slam. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 10 ft. *Hit:* 2d8 + 4 bludgeoning.

Sweep (Recharge 5-6). A wide swing; each creature within 10 ft. makes a DC 14 Dexterity save, taking 2d6 + 4 bludgeoning (half on a success) and shoved 10 ft. on a fail.

CORRUPTED SPROUTLING

Small plant (planar-corrupted), unaligned ♦ weak but many



AC 12 **HP** 7 (2d6) **Speed** 10 ft., climb 10 ft.

STR 8 **DEX** 14 **CON** 10 **INT** 2 **WIS** 6 **CHA** 4

Vulnerable fire

Senses darkvision 30 ft.

Traits

Weak but Many. Dies to almost any solid hit; an area effect clears several at once (reward AoE).

Group Turn & Spawn. All Sproutlings act together on one shared initiative. While the engine runs corrupt, a new one crawls from a crack each time one dies.

Actions

Thorn-Lash. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 1d6 + 2 piercing.

Latch. Instead of attacking, it grabs a hero (no damage); the next attack against that hero has advantage.

And then the boss: not a monster, but the city's beloved gentle giant, possessed and grieving inside its own iron. The Guardians broke its legs to bring the core into reach, and the last blow drained the corruption away rather than killing it. A gentle death, never an execution.

THE GRAND CUSTODIAN (POSSESSED)

Gargantuan construct (planar-possessed), unaligned ♦ the boss of Session 7 ♦ a two-phase fight

AC 17 (Body); Legs (x2) **AC** 15 **HP** 220 (Body); Legs 90 each **Speed** 30 ft.

STR 24 **DEX** 6 **CON** 22 **INT** 3 **WIS** 10 **CHA** 5

Resist bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Imm. (cond) charmed, frightened, exhaustion, poisoned, paralyzed, petrified

Traits

The Core Is High. Standing, the core is 40-50 ft. up: only 60-ft.+ ranged attacks and flyers reach it. The legs are ground-level and anyone can strike them.

Topple. Drop both legs (90 HP each) and it crashes to its knees (Phase 2), stops rampaging, and the core drops to 15-20 ft. within everyone's reach. It may slowly repair a leg (to 25 HP) to rise; re-topple it.

Actions

Crushing Stomp. *Melee:* +8 to hit, reach 15 ft. *Hit:* 2d10 + 5 bludgeoning, and a DC 15 Dexterity save or knocked prone. (Phases 1 and 2.)

Sweeping Backhand (Recharge 5-6). (Phase 1) A 15-ft. cone; DC 15 Dexterity save, 3d8 and shoved 10 ft. (half and no shove on a success).

Corrupt Bolt. (Phase 1) +8 to hit, range 60 ft. *Hit:* 3d8 lightning, once per round at someone hanging back.

Clockwork Barrage (Recharge 4-6). (Phase 2) Three projectiles, +8 each. *Hit:* 2d8 + 3 bludgeoning.

Chain Lightning Burst (Recharge 5-6). (Phase 2) +8 to hit, 4d8 lightning, arcing to two more within 15 ft. for 2d8 (DC 15 Dexterity save for half). Meant to be ANSWERED, not to drop a hero.

Core Flare. (Phase 2, body below half HP) Each creature within 20 ft. makes a DC 15 Constitution save or takes 2d6 force and is blinded until end of its next turn.



♦ LORE OF ELARIA ♦ The Machines Remember

Machines feel the Darkening before people do. A machine is a promise written in brass, and promises are exactly what the Weaver of Fractures unpicks first. When the mills and servitors of the world began to stumble, the made folk of Gearhaven understood it the way sailors understand a red sky, and grieved for the gentle giant most of all.

Part II: Treasures & Relics



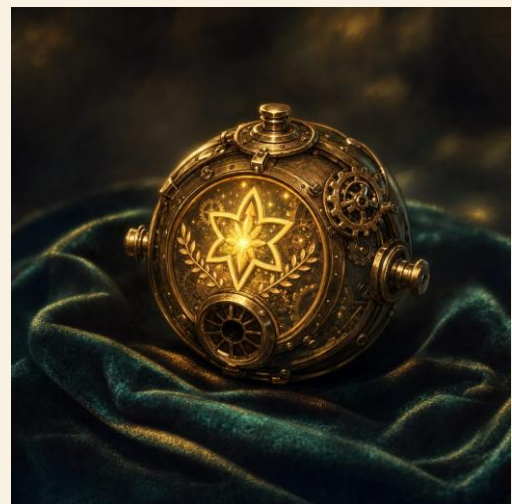
Every treasure of the Guardians' road, from a mother's parting gift to the relics of a sleeping goddess. Items marked with the seven-point star are Elaria's own.

The Great Mysteries

The Essence Sphere

Brass and crystal, warm as a heartbeat, made by the deep-gnome masters of Glimmerspire BEFORE the cracks ever opened (how they knew is a question nobody has answered). It holds Pikachu's sleeping spark, and it is a GATHERER: it pulls loose planar motes to itself and survives holding them, which no other vessel can. It is the missing anchor of Vane's Rift Portal, and it never leaves the party's keeping. Gained **Planar Attunement** at the Whispering Glade (advantage on Arcana concerning planar magic).

The Circle has no proper word for what the Sphere is, only what it does: it keeps. Whatever loose scrap of another world drifts past, the Sphere gathers it in and holds it steady, the way a lantern keeps a single flame out of the wind. Every other vessel the deep gnomes ever tried cracked, dimmed, or worse. This one only glows a little warmer, and waits.



◆ LORE OF ELARIA ◆ The Sign of Seven Points

The old tellings agree that Elaria signed her safeguards the way a mother sews a name into a coat: not so the gift would be admired, but so it could always find its way home. The seven points are said to be the seven planes she kept turning, and the leafed vine that wraps them is the world itself, holding on. When one of her gifts is near, the sign is said to warm, as if glad to be recognized.

The Three Enchanted Potatoes

Ash Catchum's legacy to his son: three unassuming potatoes that are anything but. The goddess named them **remnants of a shattered covenant**, safeguards bound from her own essence in the old lore (Healing, Transformation, Insight). They pulse when the world thins, a slow warm beat you feel in the palm more than hear, and they have never once spoiled, sprouted crooked, or agreed to be eaten. Their hour has not yet come, but the Circle is patient, and so, apparently, are the potatoes.

Ursa carries them wrapped in a cloth his father knotted, and will not say why he trusts three root vegetables with the fate of anything. He only shrugs and says they came from Ash, and that Ash was rarely wrong about which small things turned out to matter.



◆ LORE OF ELARIA ◆ The Enchanted Potatoes

The Circle keeps a very old, very short list titled "Safeguards, Probable." Entry nine reads: "The traveling potatoes. Warm to the touch. Kindly disposition. Keep planting them." Nobody knows who wrote it. The handwriting is extremely old.

Stabby's Idol



A small carved figure Stabby found tucked in his bag after Wraithpine, though nobody saw who put it there. It goes ice cold near rifts, and corruption recoils from it. It has dreams in it. That is all anyone knows, yet.

Stabby will not part with it, and cannot say why. He only knows the dark feels friendlier when the idol rides in his pack, that the coldest nights on the road are the ones it warns him of, and that once, half asleep, he heard it breathing in time with him. The idol keeps its own counsel. So, for now, does he.

◆ LORE OF ELARIA ◆ The Scattered Safeguards

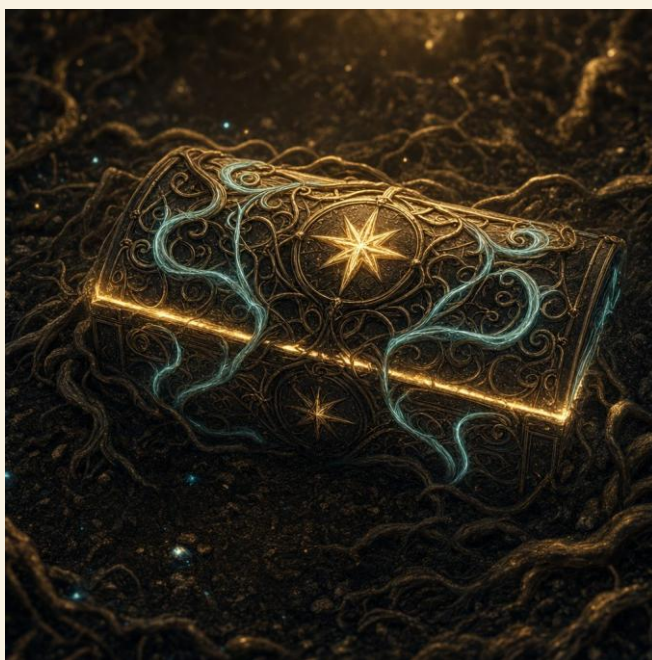
No one has ever counted the safeguards, which is the point of scattering. Some hang in plain sight in tavern rafters. Some sleep in root cellars, humble as potatoes. The old rule of the Circle is: treat every odd little thing kindly, in case it is holding up the sky.

Relics of Elaria (the Wraithpine Chest)

One half-buried chest, bound in vines of silver and root, opened by Ghostbloom's song beneath the Old Theater. Inside, three gifts, each bearing the seven-point star.

◆ LORE OF ELARIA ◆ One Chest, Three Gifts

The Circle teaches that the Warden never gave a gift to one hand alone. Her safeguards came in sets, they say, because a thing meant to hold up the sky is too heavy for any single pair of arms. The chest that opened to a song beneath the old theater held three gifts and one lesson: a stave for the sky, a sash for the swift, and a small bright core for the maker, and none of the three was meant to be carried without the other two.



The Wraithpine chest, bound in silver vines.

Staff of Waking Constellations (Ursa)

Staff of Waking Constellations

+1 quarterstaff, druidic focus. 5 charges, regain 1d4 + 1 at dawn: guiding bolt (1), faerie fire (1), moonbeam (2).

Starseed. Once per turn, +1d4 radiant when Ursa deals radiant damage with a druid spell (house rule: druid spells only).

Starlight. Bonus action: 10 ft. dim light; advantage on night navigation.

The counter-weapon: after every great victory, one new star brightens on its haft. The enemy puts stars out; the Staff lights them.

Sash of the Swift Current, Rewoven (Stabby)

Sash of the Swift Current (Rewoven)

Scarlet stage-silk rewoven with theater rigging thread. +1 AC (stacks with Unarmored Defense).

Fleetstep. +10 ft. walking speed. **Air Dance.** 1/day bonus action: fly speed equal to walking, 1 minute.

Feather Fall. 1/day, no components. Its star sigil is cupped by a pair of wings.

Glimmerspire Pocket Dynamo, Mk II (Lilly)

Glimmerspire Pocket Dynamo (Mk II)

A thumb-sized brass core stamped PROP ROOM in stage-engraver script (a mystery unexplained).

Pocket Arsenal. Deploy or recall the Eldritch Cannon as a free action. **Endurance Overhaul.** Cannon lasts 24 hours.

Power Sync. Cannon deals +2 damage. **Reformat.** 1/long rest, action: change the cannon's model.

Near Ghostbloom, the core glows soft ghost-green, like a stage cue waiting for its moment.



The Staff of Waking Constellations.



*The Sash of the Swift Current,
rewoven.*



Lilly with the Pocket Dynamo.

Gifts of Faelan (Havenmoor, Session 4)

Frostbite Shard Dagger (Lilly)

Frostbite Shard Dagger

Rare, attunement by an Artificer. Crystalline ice that never melts. 1d4 piercing + 1d4 cold, +1 to attack.

Spell focus and Arcane Firearm. +1d8 frost to one spell damage roll cast through it; +2 frost on spell damage.

Amulet of Guiding Light (Ursa)

Amulet of Guiding Light

Rare, attunement by a Circle of Stars druid.

Guiding Light. Sheds light; allies gain +1 to attacks and saves while Ursa is in Starry Form.

Starry Glow. Reaction, 1/long rest: 2d8 radiant, DC 15 Con or blinded. **Celestial Resilience.** Reroll natural 1s, 2/long rest.

Candyfang Katana (Stabby)

Candyfang Katana

Rare, attunement by a Monk. A katana of impossible candy-cane steel. 1d8/1d10 slashing, +1 attack and damage.

Sugar Rush. Bonus action lick, 1/long rest: 2d8 + Con temporary HP. **Frostbite Infusion.** +2 frost on hit. Destined to become a Bloodfang heirloom when the Nichirin blade comes.



The Frostbite Shard Dagger.



The Amulet of Guiding Light.



The Candyfang Katana.

Boons, Baubles & Blessings

Elaria's boons (the Whispering Glade, Session 2): Ursa, Planar Awareness (sense planar disturbances, 24 hours); Lilly, the Sphere's Planar Attunement; Stabby, Glimpse of Possibility (one reroll, because the goddess smiled at the goblin).

The eight Winter Bells (Session 4). C, D, E, F, G, A, B, High C: relics of Elaria's light hidden across Havenmoor. Rung in harmony they unmade the Krampusshade. **Faelan's Frosted Cookies:** 2d8 healing, a short rest's comfort, and one spell slot, in cookie form.

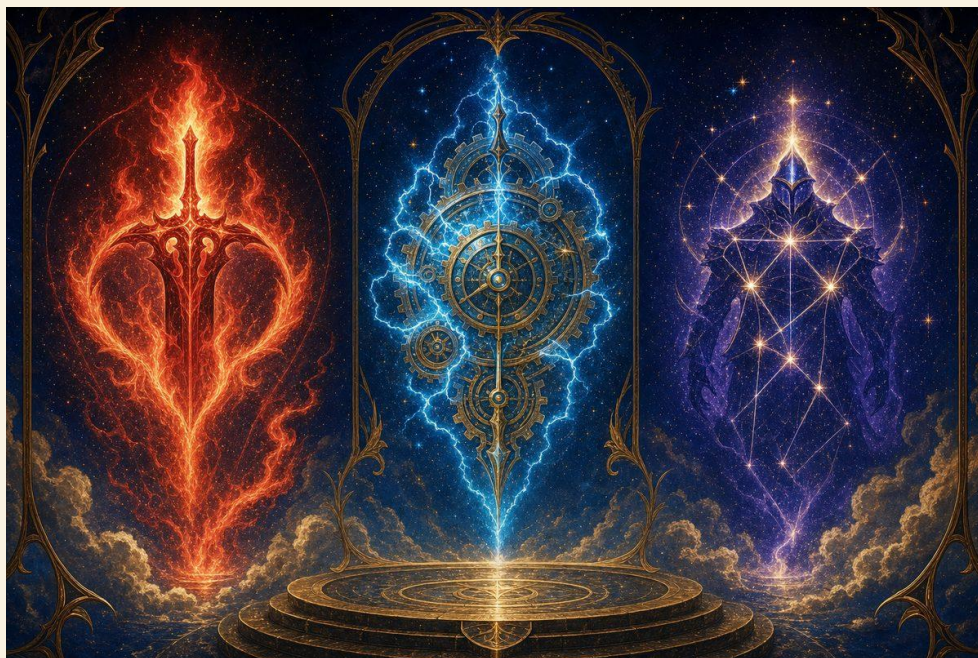
Curios of the road. The Shadow-Touched Rune Fragment (advantage vs fear, 1 hour); the Dark Fragment of Stormwatch Cliffs (crystallized chaos, evidence of sabotage); Terranox's stone fragments and the elemental mud samples of the Grove of Elemental Waters; beeswax earplugs that beat a monster's song; a bell-handled blue lantern from Pumpkin Row; Alwen's flasks of lucky seawater.



◆ LORE OF ELARIA ◆ The Bells of the Coast

When the safeguards were scattered, eight fell along the southern coast as bells, each holding one clear note of the song Elaria sang while she worked. Havenmoor built its festival around them centuries before anyone remembered why the bells mattered. The town rang them every winter anyway. Traditions are how a town remembers what its people forget, and one winter the ringing unmade a fiend.

Part III: Custom Content



Homebrew and rulings of this table: the paths the heroes may walk after the year apart, and the standing rules of the campaign. 2024 rules throughout; house rules override the books. The heroes themselves, every number, slot, and spell, now live in Part IV: The Guardians' Character Sheets.

House Rules & Standing Rulings

House rules (adjudications beyond the printed rules).

1. Ursa's Starseed +1d4 applies only to actual druid spells, never the Starry Form Archer's luminous arrow.
2. Potent Spellcasting rides the kindled staff once per turn (Ursa, from level 7; no double-dipping with a cantrip in the same turn).

2024 notes (these are the printed rules, recorded so the table never slips back to older text). Patient Defense's free tier is Disengage; Dodge costs 1 Focus Point. Eating a Goodberry is a Bonus Action. Shillelagh replaced Primal Savagery on Ursa's sheet. Deep gnome uses the current printing (Svirfneblin Camouflage; Disguise Self and Nondetection 1/long rest each). The Eldritch Cannon picks its mode on every activation. The Air Bestial Spirit has 20 Hit Points by its own stat block.

◆ LORE OF ELARIA ◆ The First Listeners

Before there were villages there were listeners. The first druids did not learn magic; they learned quiet, and the forests, glad of the company, taught them the rest. The Circle of the Eternal Stars still opens every gathering with a full minute of silence, in honor of the age when that was the whole religion.

The Three Doors

At the close of the Gearhaven chapter the Guardians parted for a year: a year of workshops and roads and night skies, each hero following their own heart home. Before each of them stand three doors, three ways that year apart might be spent, and behind every door waits a different gift.

The chapters that follow set down what waits behind all nine: Stabby's three breathing styles, Ursa's three paths of the stars, and Lilly's three artifacts. Each Guardian will choose exactly one door, and none of the three has chosen yet. When they do, the doors not taken will remain in these pages, roads not walked, ready for other heroes in other tellings.



Stabby, before the three breathing styles.



Ursa, before the three paths of the stars.



Lilly, before the three artifacts.

◆ LORE OF ELARIA ◆ The Roads Not Taken

The old tellings are gentle about the doors a hero leaves closed. A road not walked is not a road lost, the Circle says, only a road lent to someone else. Every path in these pages was true; a Guardian simply cannot be three heroes at once, and the year apart is the world's kind way of asking each of them who they most wish to become.



The parting at Gearhaven's gates: three friends, three roads, one year.

Warrior of Breathing (Stabby's Path)

A homebrew monk subclass taken at level 7 in place of Kensei. A Warrior of Breathing kindles an inner style, a visible breath that wreathes the blade. Three doors, three breathing styles; every road grants the **Nichirin Katana**, and every First Form replaces Flurry of Blows. The full text of all three follows.

◆ LORE OF ELARIA ◆ What a Breathing Style Is

The mountain monks say a breathing style is not a trick of the lungs but a way of remembering. Every warrior carries a wild thing, a still river, and a patch of honest dark somewhere inside them; a breathing style is simply the practice of calling one of them up on purpose, and setting it down again when the fight is done. The breath, the old masters warn, is easy to light and hard to quench, which is why they teach the quenching first.

Beast Breathing: the Bloodfang Form

“You think too much, little storm. The beast does not think. The beast moves, and the beast is already behind you.” (the lesson Stabby finally understood)

Some warriors learn to still the storm inside them. The Warrior of Beast Breathing learns to ride it. Where other monks seek calm, this form reaches into the wild, animal heart of the fighter: the part that does not hesitate, does not flinch, and does not stop. Practitioners breathe in time with a racing heartbeat rather than a slow one, and when they ignite their breath, their blade glows blood-red and their body moves with the loping, unstoppable grace of a hunting beast.

It is a form born of survival rather than discipline, favored by those who grew up where the strong eat and the slow are eaten. To master it is not to tame the beast, but to become it on command, and to remember how to set it down again afterward.



Features by Monk Level. You gain Warrior of Beast Breathing features at Monk levels 3 (Beast Breathing), 6 (First Form: Devour), 11 (Advanced Beast Breathing), and 17 (Third Form: Apex Predator).

Level 3: Beast Breathing

Monk Weapons. A katana, as well as any sword you adopt as your signature blade, counts as a Monk weapon for you. You can use your Martial Arts die with it, and you can use this subclass's features with it. You can still make an Unarmed Strike as a Bonus Action.

Beast Sense. Your senses are sharp as a hunting animal's, even out of combat. You have Advantage on Wisdom (Survival) checks made to track creatures, on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on smell or hearing, and on Charisma (Intimidation) checks.

Igniting the Breath. When you roll Initiative, you can expend 1 Focus Point to ignite your breath. It lasts until the combat ends, until you have the Incapacitated condition, or until you end it (no action required).

While your breath is ignited, your weapon glows blood-red, and whenever you hit a target with it, the target takes an extra 2 Force damage.

Beast's Vigor. While your breath is ignited, your Speed increases by 10 feet, and you have Advantage on Dexterity saving throws.

Level 6: First Form: Devour

First Form: Devour. As a Bonus Action, you can expend 1 Focus Point to move up to 15 feet without provoking Opportunity Attacks and make one attack with your Monk weapon. On a hit, the target takes Force damage equal to 3d8 plus your Dexterity modifier instead of the weapon's normal damage. Bonuses to the weapon's damage rolls (such as the Nichirin katana's +2 bonus and the extra damage from your ignited breath) apply as normal. If the attack reduces the target to 0 Hit Points, you regain the expended Focus Point. This feature replaces Flurry of Blows for you.

Level 11: Advanced Beast Breathing

Advanced Breathing. Your ignited breath grows fiercer. While your breath is ignited, you retain all its other benefits, you have Resistance to Bludgeoning, Piercing, and Slashing damage, and the extra Force damage your weapon deals increases from 2 to 3.

Sharpened Fang. The damage of your First Form: Devour increases to 5d10 plus your Dexterity modifier.

Level 17: Third Form: Apex Predator

Third Form: Apex Predator. You become a blur of fang and steel. As a Bonus Action, you can expend 3 Focus Points to move up to your Speed without provoking Opportunity Attacks and make one attack with your Monk weapon against each of up to three different creatures you move within reach of. On a hit, the target takes Force damage equal to 5d10 plus your Dexterity modifier instead of the weapon's normal damage. Bonuses to the weapon's damage rolls (such as the Nichirin katana's +2 bonus and the extra damage from your ignited breath) apply as normal. Each creature hit must succeed on a Strength saving throw (DC 8 plus your Wisdom modifier and Proficiency Bonus) or have the Prone condition. You regain 1 expended Focus Point for each creature this feature reduces to 0 Hit Points.

Water Breathing: the Monastery Form

"Be water. Water does not strike; it flows, and the rock is cut all the same. Now breathe, and begin again." (Master Kaelon Windstep)

The Warrior of Water Breathing is the form of the patient master, the discipline that other monks spend their whole lives chasing. Its practitioners learn to move like a river: never rigid, never still, every strike flowing into the next, every blow turned aside by giving way rather than resisting. When they ignite their breath, their blade runs pale blue and cold, and their guard becomes as fluid and unbroken as a current that cannot be grasped.

It is the most traditional of the breathing forms, and the hardest to truly master, for it asks the warrior to be calm in the middle of chaos. Those who walk this path are as often menders as fighters, for the same stillness that turns a blade can also close a wound, and the same patience that wins a duel can sit a long vigil at a friend's side.



Features by Monk Level. You gain Warrior of Water Breathing features at Monk levels 3 (Water Breathing), 6 (First Form: Flowing Strike and Healing Spring, First Water), 11 (Advanced Water Breathing and the full Healing Spring), and 17 (Third Form: Tidal Crash).

Level 3: Water Breathing

Monk Weapons. A katana, as well as any sword you adopt as your signature blade, counts as a Monk weapon for you. You can use your Martial Arts die with it, and you can use this subclass's features with it. You can still make an Unarmed Strike as a Bonus Action.

Igniting the Breath. When you roll Initiative, you can expend 1 Focus Point to ignite your breath. It lasts until the combat ends, until you have the Incapacitated condition, or until you end it (no action required). While your breath is ignited, your weapon glows pale blue, and whenever you hit a target with it, the target takes an extra 2 Cold damage.

Flowing Guard. While your breath is ignited, you gain a +2 bonus to Armor Class against the first attack roll made against you before the start of each of your turns.

Level 6: First Form: Flowing Strike

First Form: Flowing Strike. As a Bonus Action, you can expend 1 Focus Point to move up to 15 feet without provoking Opportunity Attacks and make one attack with your Monk weapon. On a hit, the target takes Cold damage equal to 3d8 plus your Dexterity modifier instead of the weapon's normal damage. Bonuses to the weapon's damage rolls (such as the Nichirin katana's +2 bonus and the extra damage from your ignited breath) apply as normal. If the attack hits, the target must also succeed on a Dexterity saving throw (DC 8 plus your Wisdom modifier and Proficiency Bonus) or have the Prone condition. This feature replaces Flurry of Blows for you.

Healing Spring (First Water). As a Bonus Action, you can touch yourself or another creature, and the target regains a number of Hit Points equal to 2d8 plus your Wisdom modifier. Once you use this benefit, you can't use it again until you finish a Short or Long Rest. This benefit improves when you reach Monk level 11 (Healing Spring).

Level 11: Advanced Water Breathing

Advanced Breathing. Your ignited breath deepens. While your breath is ignited, you retain all its other benefits, and whenever you hit a creature with your Monk weapon, that creature's Speed is reduced by 10 feet until the start of your next turn.

Sharpened Flow. The damage of your First Form: Flowing Strike increases to 5d10 plus your Dexterity modifier.

Healing Spring. When you use your Healing Spring, the target now regains a number of Hit Points equal to 4d8 plus your Wisdom modifier. Once you use this benefit, you can't use it again until you finish a Short or Long Rest.

Level 17: Third Form: Tidal Crash

Third Form: Tidal Crash. As a Bonus Action, you can expend 3 Focus Points to move up to 20 feet and make one attack with your Monk weapon against each of up to three different creatures within your reach during that movement. On a hit, the target takes Cold damage equal to 5d10 plus your Dexterity modifier instead of the weapon's normal damage. Bonuses to the weapon's damage rolls (such as the Nichirin katana's +2 bonus and the extra damage from your ignited breath) apply as normal. Each creature hit must succeed on a Dexterity saving throw (DC 8 plus your Wisdom modifier and Proficiency Bonus) or have the Prone condition and a Speed of 0 until the end of its next turn.

Shadow Breathing: the Idol Form

"Do not fear the dark. Breathe it in. Let it fill you, and then there is nothing left in the dark to fear you." (a whisper from the idol)

The Warrior of Shadow Breathing is the strangest and most secretive of the forms, a discipline touched by something older than any monastery. Its practitioners breathe in the gloom itself, drawing the dark into their lungs until it answers to them. When they ignite their breath, their blade runs violet-black, the shadows fold around them like a cloak, and they see clearly in darkness that blinds everyone else.

Few teach this form openly, for it walks close to powers most monks are warned away from. Those who carry it often carry a question they cannot yet answer: why the dark heeds them, where the breath truly comes from, and what waits at the end of the path they have started down. Mastered well, it makes a warrior into something the night itself seems to bend around.



Features by Monk Level. You gain Warrior of Shadow Breathing features at Monk levels 3 (Shadow Breathing), 6 (First Form: Umbral Slash), 11 (Advanced Shadow Breathing), and 17 (Third Form: Eclipse).

Level 3: Shadow Breathing

Monk Weapons. A katana, as well as any sword you adopt as your signature blade, counts as a Monk weapon for you. You can use your Martial Arts die with it, and you can use this subclass's features with it. You can still make an Unarmed Strike as a Bonus Action.

Eyes of the Idol. The idol's gift never fully leaves you. You have Darkvision with a range of 60 feet (if you already have Darkvision, its range increases by 60 feet), and you have Advantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks.

Igniting the Breath. When you roll Initiative, you can expend 1 Focus Point to ignite your breath. It lasts until the combat ends, until you have the Incapacitated condition, or until you end it (no action required). While your breath is ignited, your weapon glows violet-black, and whenever you hit a target with it, the target takes an extra 2 Necrotic damage.

One With the Gloom. While your breath is ignited, you gain a +2 bonus to Armor Class against ranged attack rolls, and you can see normally in magical Darkness.

Level 6: First Form: Umbral Slash

First Form: Umbral Slash. As a Bonus Action, you can expend 1 Focus Point to teleport up to 15 feet to an unoccupied space you can see within 5 feet of a creature. Magical Darkness then fills a 10-foot Cube of your choice, which must contain that creature's space. You then make one attack with your Monk weapon against that creature, and you have Advantage on the attack roll. On a hit, the target takes Necrotic damage equal to 3d8 plus your Dexterity modifier instead of the weapon's normal damage. Bonuses to the weapon's damage rolls (such as the Nichirin katana's +2 bonus and the extra damage from your ignited breath) apply as normal.

You can see through Darkness created by this feature. The Darkness lasts until the end of your next turn, or you can end it early (no action required). This feature replaces Flurry of Blows for you.

► The gloom is his alone. Stabby sees through his own Darkness; his allies cannot. Allies make ranged attack rolls with Disadvantage against a creature wrapped in the gloom, and spells that require a visible target cannot reach it at all, so the party learns to pick different targets while the shadow does its work.

Level 11: Advanced Shadow Breathing

Advanced Breathing. Your ignited breath drinks deeper of the dark. While your breath is ignited, you retain all its other benefits. In addition, once per turn when you hit a creature with an attack roll that had Advantage, the target takes an extra 2d6 Necrotic damage.

Sharpened Gloom. The damage of your First Form: Umbral Slash increases to 5d10 plus your Dexterity modifier.

Level 17: Third Form: Eclipse

Third Form: Eclipse. You vanish into the gloom and strike from everywhere at once. As a Bonus Action, you can expend 3 Focus Points to fill a 20-foot Cube centered on yourself with magical Darkness, which you can see through. For each of up to three different creatures in the Cube, you can teleport to an unoccupied space you can see within 5 feet of that creature and make one attack with your Monk weapon against it, and you have Advantage on each attack roll. On a hit, the target takes Necrotic damage equal to 5d10 plus your Dexterity modifier instead of the weapon's normal damage. Bonuses to the weapon's damage rolls (such as the Nichirin katana's +2 bonus and the extra damage from your ignited breath) apply as normal. Each creature hit has the Blinded condition until the end of your next turn, and creatures other than you can't see you until the Darkness ends.

The Demon-Slayer's Blade: the Nichirin Katana

This sun-forged demon-slayer blade was made from crimson ore that drinks in dawnlight. While sheathed, the steel looks dark and almost ordinary, but when Stabby ignites his breathing, the blade catches that breath and burns with the color of his chosen form.

Nichirin Katana

Weapon (Katana), Rare (Requires Attunement by Stabby)

Weapon Statistics. The Nichirin katana uses the statistics of a Longsword (1d8 Slashing damage) and has the Finesse and Versatile (1d10) properties, and it counts as a Monk weapon for you. Because the weapon has the Finesse property and is a Monk weapon for you, you can use your Dexterity modifier for its attack and damage rolls.

Magic Weapon. You gain a +2 bonus to attack rolls and damage rolls made with this magic weapon.

Breath-Kindled Steel. When you ignite your breathing, the blade glows with the color and nature of that form: blood-red for Beast Breathing, pale blue for Water Breathing, or violet-black for Shadow Breathing. This glow is magical but sheds only Dim Light unless you choose otherwise.

Cleansing Edge. Once per turn when you hit a Fiend, an Undead, a shadow creature, or a creature empowered by planar corruption with this weapon, the blade burns away corruption until the start of your next turn. Until then, the target can't regain Hit Points and can't benefit from magical Darkness or shadowy concealment against you. Any visible corruption around the wound briefly burns, cracks, or peels away in sparks of purified light.

The blade wounds the corruption, not the creature beneath; when a corrupted guardian falls to it, what breaks is the darkness.



The Nichirin Katana: dark steel waiting for dawnlight.

Lore of the Blade

They say the first Nichirin blades were quenched not in water or oil but in the light of dawn itself, folded by smiths who worked only in the hour before sunrise. The ore came from a single mountain that caught the morning sun before anywhere else in the world, and steel drawn from it never forgot that first warmth. A finished blade looks plain and dark in an idle hand; it is waiting. Only a warrior who can kindle their own breath can wake the color sleeping in the metal.

For a creature of corruption, that waking light is a death sentence. Where an ordinary sword cuts flesh, a Nichirin blade cuts the rot itself: the shadow that hides a fiend, the dark magic that knits an undead back together, the planar taint that lets a horror shrug off honest steel. Stabby's blade chose its colors from his own breathing forms, and now it burns red, blue, or violet to match whichever beast, river, or shadow he calls upon.

A whispered rumor. Old hunters claim a Nichirin blade can never be truly stolen: carried by the wrong hand, the steel stays cold and dull and will not take an edge. No one in living memory has dared find out.

Setting Down the Kensei's Way

When Stabby takes up a breathing form at Level 7, the Kensei's tricks retire with his old teacher's lessons: Kensei's Shot and Agile Parry go, and the Repeating Longbow becomes simply a very good bow. In exchange he gains a stance he can ignite every single fight, a First Form that turns his Bonus Action into a 3d8 + 5 strike with 15 feet of free movement, and a road that grows with him to Level 17. He is trading a parry for a predator's gait. (And Candyfang remains: an heirloom at his belt, or one day a gift worthy of a Bloodfang.)

Paths of the Stars (Ursa's Path)

For Ursa Catchum, Circle of the Stars Druid: the year apart, Level 5 to 7. Ursa walked one of three roads during the year apart, and came back changed. Each road deepens something Ursa already does: his summons, his starry form, or his omens. Each road grants a feat (what he sought) and a keepsake (what found him): he gains the pair matching his road. These are special story feats: they grant no Ability Score Increase.

◆ LORE OF ELARIA ◆ The Star-Paths of the Circle

The Circle holds that no druid chooses the stars; the stars choose, and the druid only walks to meet them. Three roads are said to open before a sky-reader who has served the Circle well: one into the wild, where the living world answers; one into the sky, where the constellations lend their light; and one along a father's trail, where the omens stop coming at random and begin, at last, to obey. A druid walks one road and comes back changed, and the two roads not taken wait, patient as starlight, for whoever comes next.

Beast Handler: The Living World (the road into the wild)

"You went out to learn the speech of wild things. You came back, and three of them followed you home."

Beast Handler (feat)

Story Feat

You gain the following benefits.

Mightier Summons. Whenever you cast the Summon Beast spell, the spell takes effect as if you had cast it using a spell slot of the highest level you can cast, without expending a slot of that level.

Signature Partners. Your Summon Beast spell no longer conjures a nameless spirit. When you cast the spell, one of your three partners answers the call: Arcanine, Lapras, or Noctowl. The partner uses the Signature Partner stat block below, with the traits and actions marked for it.

Wild Speech. You and any beast you summon can communicate simple ideas with each other telepathically.

Ursa walked the wild year with three companions, and they answer his call still. These are not spirits wearing borrowed shapes; they are his friends, and he named each one the day it chose him.



Arcanine, the Land partner.



Lapras, the Water partner.



Noctowl, the Air partner.

Signature Partner

Beast (Arcanine: Medium, Land. Lapras: Large, Water. Noctowl: Small, Air), Unaligned

Armor Class: 11 + the level of the spell (natural armor)

Hit Points: 30 + 10 for each spell level above 2 (Noctowl: 20 + 10 for each spell level above 2nd)

Speed: 40 ft., climb 40 ft. (Arcanine only); 30 ft., swim 40 ft. (Lapras only); 20 ft., fly 60 ft. (Noctowl only)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	11 (+0)	16 (+3)	4 (−3)	14 (+2)	5 (−3)

Damage Vulnerabilities: Cold (Arcanine only); Lightning (Lapras and Noctowl only)

Damage Immunities: Fire (Arcanine only); Cold (Lapras only); Necrotic (Noctowl only)

Senses: darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 12

Languages: understands the languages you speak

Challenge: None

Proficiency Bonus: equals your bonus

Traits

Intimidate (Arcanine Only). When the partner appears, each enemy within 15 feet of it must succeed on a Wisdom saving throw against your spell save DC or take a −2 penalty to attack rolls until the end of its next turn.

Shell Armor (Lapras Only). Attack rolls against the partner can't be Critical Hits.

Keen Eye (Noctowl Only). The partner's attack rolls can't have Disadvantage, and its sight isn't impeded by Dim Light or Darkness.

Flyby (Noctowl Only). The partner doesn't provoke Opportunity Attacks when it flies out of an enemy's reach.

Actions

Multiattack. The partner makes a number of Rend attacks equal to half this spell's level (round down).

Rend. *Melee Attack Roll:* your spell attack modifier, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 1d8 + 4 + the spell's level Slashing damage.

Extreme Speed (Arcanine Only). The partner moves up to its Speed without provoking Opportunity Attacks and makes one Rend attack. On a hit, the target takes extra Fire damage equal to twice the spell's level.

Ice Beam (Lapras Only). When the partner uses Multiattack, it can replace any Rend with an Ice Beam. *Ranged Attack Roll:* your spell attack modifier, range 60 ft. *Hit:* 1d8 + 4 + the spell's level Cold damage, and the target's Speed decreases by 10 feet until the start of the partner's next turn.

Hypnosis (Noctowl Only; Recharge 5–6). One creature the partner can see within 30 feet must succeed on a Wisdom saving throw against your spell save DC or have the Incapacitated condition until the end of the partner's next turn or until it takes damage.

Arcanine. *Legendary for its speed, it is said to run six thousand miles in a day and a night, driven by a flame that burns within. The old tales say folk stood entranced just watching it run.*

Lapras. *Intelligent enough to understand speech, it ferries travelers across cold water on its broad back, and it sings where sailors can hear.*

Noctowl. *Its eyes see by the faintest starlight, its head turns all the way around when it thinks, and its wings make no sound at all.*

The Wildheart Token

Wondrous Item (carved by his own hand)

Three small totems strung on one leather cord, one for each partner, whittled beside the wild year's campfires. When a partner you summoned would drop to 0 Hit Points, it drops to 1 Hit Point instead. Once this property is used, it can't be used again until the next dawn.

► Naming is a table ceremony: the player names each partner the first time Ursa calls it, exactly like a first catch, and the chosen names go into the printed book alongside the species. Base creatures locked by the DM 2026-07-13: Arcanine, Lapras, and Noctowl, played as realistic-fantasy reskins.

Starlit Channeler: The Circle of Stars (the road into the sky)

“You returned to the Circle, and every constellation answered: their light now runs down your arm and out through the staff. Whatever stars you wear, the Warden's spear sweeps between danger and the party.”



The Warden stands guard in Ursa's starlight.

Starlit Channeler (feat)

Story Feat (Prerequisite: Starry Form Feature)

You gain the following benefits.

The Warden's Mantle. You learn the Shillelagh cantrip, and Wisdom is your spellcasting ability for it. When you assume your Starry Form, you cast Shillelagh through your Staff of Waking Constellations as part of the same Bonus Action, and the spell lasts until the form ends rather than for 1 minute. While your Starry Form is active, whichever constellation you chose: the Staff's Starlight kindles with the form (no action required) and reaches 20 feet, and each ally within that light gains a +1 bonus to attack rolls and saving throws; the kindled staff deals Radiant damage, and when you hit with it, the target takes an extra 1d6 Radiant damage (this extra damage increases to 2d6 at Druid level 11 and 3d6 at Druid level 17); and the Warden, a spear-bearing figure of starlight, stands guard in your glow.

Warden's Intercession. While your Starry Form is active, when a creature you can see hits an ally within your Starlight, you can take a Reaction to reduce the damage the ally takes by 1d8 plus your Wisdom modifier.

Constellation Gifts. While your Starry Form is active, you also gain the benefit below for the constellation you chose.

Archer. When you hit a creature with the Archer's luminous arrow, the arrow's light clings to it, and the next attack roll made against that creature before the start of your next turn has Advantage.

Chalice. When the Chalice's light restores Hit Points, you can divide those Hit Points between two creatures within 30 feet of yourself.

Dragon. Allies within your Starlight can treat a d20 roll of 9 or lower as a 10 on Constitution saving throws to maintain Concentration.

► The kindled staff IS the Shillelagh spell, so Starseed (+1d4) rides its strikes once per turn (house rule 1; never the Archer's arrow), and its damage counts as cantrip damage (Potent Spellcasting applies from Druid level 7, once per turn, house rule 2). The Warden is no longer a fourth constellation to pick: the mantle rides every form (DM ruling 2026-07-13). Sheet note: the feat grants Shillelagh, so Ursa's known copy frees up for a swap.

The Staff Wakes Further

The relic grows, as promised. The Staff of Waking Constellations has always brightened a new star after every victory; on this road, it brightens for him. It is the vessel the Warden shines through: when the constellation widens its Starlight to 20 feet, it is this staff carrying the light, and the whole party fits inside it. The staff now has 6 charges and regains 1d4 + 2 expended charges daily at dawn.

Reader of Omens: The Father's Trail (the road east)

“Your father read the sky the way other folk read a map. On his trail you learned his art: the omens no longer come at random, and you choose your moment.”



At dawn the stone dreams the day to come.

Reader of Omens (feat)

Story Feat (Prerequisite: Cosmic Omen Feature)

You gain the following benefits.

Omen Dreams. When you finish a Long Rest, roll two d20s and record the numbers rolled. These are your omens for the day. When you or a creature you can see is about to make a D20 Test, you can replace the d20 roll with one of your omens (no action required). You must choose to do so before the roll, and you can use each omen only once. When you finish a Long Rest, you lose any unused omens.

Both Omens. When you consult your Star Map after finishing a Long Rest, you don't roll for a single omen. Instead, you gain access to both Weal and Woe until your next Long Rest.

Read the Moment. When you take the Reaction granted by your Cosmic Omen feature, you can wait until after the d20 is rolled but before you know whether the roll succeeds or fails. You then choose whether to apply Weal (adding 1d6 to the roll) or Woe (subtracting 1d6 from it).

Shared Tides. Your uses of Cosmic Omen remain a single pool: you can use the feature a number of times equal to your Wisdom modifier, expending one use on either Weal or Woe, and you regain all expended uses when you finish a Long Rest.

► Cosmic Omen is the Circle of Stars feature Ursa gained at Druid level 6.

Woe lands after the die is cast: turning an enemy's save into a failure at the perfect moment feels like fate itself.

The dreamed day has its own table craft: when an omen is spent, Ursa's player speaks the dreamed number aloud before the die would fall. "I dreamed this. The arrow lands on a 3." Watching the world obey the dream is the whole art.

Ash's Sigil-Stone

Wondrous Item, Rare (Requires Attunement by Ursa)

A river-smooth stone etched with a half-finished sigil of Elaria, in Ash's own hand. Recovered on the trail, it sits warm in the palm whenever it is carried east. Cast between fights, it knits the party whole and kindles Ursa's Chalice splash besides. One day, when the sigil is finished, it may wake.

While holding the stone, you can cast Aura of Vitality from it without expending a spell slot. Once this property is used, it can't be used again until you finish a Long Rest.

The Stone Looks Ahead. The stone has 2 charges and regains all expended charges daily at dawn. As a Magic action, you can expend 1 charge to do one of the following.

Ask the Day. Ask the DM one yes-or-no question about the day ahead. You receive a truthful "yes" or "no," or silence if the answer cannot be known.

Glimpse the Trail. Learn what waits on one unrevealed rift-board space within 1 mile.

Read the Heart. Learn a visible creature's emotional state and attitude toward the party.

With the Staff and the Amulet, the Stone closes Ursa's third and final attunement slot.

► The Session 12 clue rides here.

Ursa gains the one road he walked, feat and keepsake together. The other two roads remain: the stars are patient, and the wild does not forget him.

Glimmerstone Artifacts (Lilly's Path)

Three masterworks of deep gnome artifice, forged for Lilly Glimmergear in the year apart. Three masterworks, one choice. Each door of Lilly's year apart leads to one of these treasures: stay and build the portal (the Sentinel), go home to Glimmerspire and Poots (the Storm Cell), or give the year to mote research (the Awakened Sphere). And on every road she carries Boomstick, Poots's parting work: a Level 7 Artillerist does not walk into the rifts without her sidearm. Boomstick takes the dagger's watch on every road, so the Frostbite Shard retires to her belt, unattuned, a keepsake and one day a gift. The attunement ledger runs light: the Sphere's road holds two of three (Dynamo, Sphere); the Sentinel's road just one (the guardian itself, the Dynamo rebuilt inside it); the Storm Cell's road two (Dynamo, the Cell). Room to grow on every path.

Boomstick, Poots's Parting Work

"It doesn't jam. It doesn't misfire. It simply states its opinion, loudly."

Whichever road Lilly walks, a parcel finds her, wrapped in waxed paper and string, postmarked Glimmerspire. Boomstick becomes her spellcasting focus and her designated Arcane Firearm (an artificer designates only one). With her shield in the other hand, her hands are exactly full: pistol, shield, and nothing wasted. Its clockwork drum conjures its own rounds, so Lilly will never want for ammunition again.



Boomstick

Weapon (Repeating Pistol), Rare

Repeating Pistol, +2. You gain a +2 bonus to attack rolls and damage rolls made with this magic weapon, which deals 1d10 Thunder damage on a hit. The weapon requires no ammunition and never needs reloading.

Spell Focus and Arcane Firearm. While holding Boomstick, you can use it as a Spellcasting Focus for your Artificer spells, and it is your designated Arcane Firearm. When you cast an Artificer spell through Boomstick, you can add 1d8 to one of the spell's damage rolls; the extra damage is Thunder damage.

Forged by the masters of Glimmerstone.

Boomstick, Stormcharged (the Storm Cell)

"Gearhaven runs on lightning. So does she, now."



Poots's brightest student, and the bottled lightning of Glimmerspire.

On this road Lilly goes home to Glimmerspire, and the masters open the deep workshops for Poots's brightest student. What she brings back is the Storm Cell: a humming capacitor drum fitted to Boomstick's frame, charged each night with bottled lightning, Gearhaven's own element.

The Storm Cell

Wondrous Item (Boomstick augmentation), Rare (Requires Attunement by Lilly)

Wand of the War Mage. While holding Boomstick, you gain a +2 bonus to spell attack rolls, and you ignore Half Cover when making a spell attack. Your Eldritch Cannon also gains a +2 bonus to its attack rolls.

Storm-Arc. The drum never stops humming. Whenever you hit a creature with Boomstick, the shot crackles: the target takes an extra 1d6 Lightning damage, and lightning arcs from it to up to two other creatures of your choice within 15 feet of it. Each arced creature must make a Dexterity saving throw against your spell save DC, taking 2d6 Lightning damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one.

Charged Rounds. The Storm Cell holds two Thunder Wave Rounds and two Counter-Bolts, and you regain all expended rounds when you finish a Long Rest. If a round requires a saving throw, the DC equals your spell save DC.

Thunder Wave Round. When you hit a creature with Boomstick, you can expend one Thunder Wave Round to overload the shot: the target takes an extra 1d10 Lightning damage and must succeed on a Constitution saving throw or have the Stunned condition until the end of your next turn.

Counter-Bolt. When a creature you can see within 60 feet makes an attack roll against one of your allies, you can take a Reaction and expend one Counter-Bolt to fire into the attack: the triggering attack roll has Disadvantage, and you make one Boomstick attack against the creature. On a hit, it takes an extra 1d10 Lightning damage.

Made to Channel. When you cast True Strike using Boomstick, the attack uses your Intelligence and counts as a spell attack, gaining the Storm Cell's +2 bonus to spell attack rolls and ignoring Half Cover. On a hit, the attack deals Boomstick's Thunder damage plus the spell's Radiant damage.

Fitted by the masters of Glimmerstone, in the workshop where Boomstick was born.

The Awakened Essence Sphere

"It was never a keepsake. It was a key, and it is finally awake."

The Sphere has spent the whole journey quietly pulling loose motes from the air. Now awakened, it holds a swirling jumble of collected aether that powers it from the start, and as the party clears each elemental rift and installs its pure Mote, the Sphere learns that plane's mighty discharge. The Sphere is honest about its bargain: at Session 8 it grants Aether Ward alone (twice per Short Rest), and every one of its five discharges sleeps behind a rift still to be won. What it builds toward is a toolbox of five distinct answers on a strict budget (a firestorm, a lull that stills a warband, a wind at every ally's back, the ground turned weapon, and a shadow's hungry pull), each the size of a spell Lilly has no slot to cast, two of them burning for a full minute while her hands stay free for the cannon. The Sphere bridges the gap between an Artificer and a full caster; it never erases it.



The Awakened Essence Sphere

Wondrous Item, Rare (Requires Attunement by Lilly)

Mote Channeling. The Sphere's powers share a pool of 2 uses, and you regain all expended uses when you finish a Short Rest. The Sphere starts with the Aether Ward power, and it gains one Elemental Discharge each time a rift's Mote is installed in it. If one of the Sphere's powers requires a saving throw, the DC equals your spell save DC.

Aether Ward (Base Power). As a Magic action, you can expend 1 use to release the gathered motes as a protective shell. You and each ally within 15 feet of you gain a number of Temporary Hit Points equal to 2d8 plus your Intelligence modifier.

Lingering Discharges. A discharge that lasts for 1 minute is sustained by the Sphere and doesn't require Concentration. The Sphere can sustain only one lingering discharge at a time; if you activate a lingering discharge while another is active, the earlier one ends. You can end a lingering discharge early (no action required).

Rift Tracker. When a rift's Mote is installed in the Sphere, record it: Ignis, Unda, Aer, Terra, Umbra.

Elemental Discharges

Each unlocks when its rift is cleared and its Mote installed. The menu grows as the campaign goes.

Fire / Ignis, Cinderstorm (LOCKED). As a Magic action, you can expend 1 use to unleash a firestorm that fills a 40-foot-radius Sphere centered on a point within 120 feet of yourself. Each creature in the Sphere must make a Dexterity saving throw, taking 8d6 Fire damage on a failed save or half as much damage on a successful one. Until the start of your next turn, the area burns: it is Difficult Terrain, and any creature that enters the area or starts its turn there takes 2d6 Fire damage.

Water / Unda, the Drowning Lull (LOCKED). As a Magic action, you can expend 1 use to fill a 20-foot-radius Sphere centered on a point within 120 feet of yourself with the sound and shimmer of deep water. Each creature in the Sphere must succeed on a Wisdom saving throw or have the Incapacitated condition and a Speed of 0 as it stands entranced, staring into deep water only it can see. The lull lasts for 1 minute. It ends early for a creature that takes damage or if another creature within 5 feet of it takes an action to shake it awake.

Air / Aer, Tailwind (LOCKED). As a Magic action, you can expend 1 use to send a following wind about your allies. For 1 minute, you and any number of allies within 30 feet of you gain a +2 bonus to attack rolls and saving throws, and your Speeds increase by 10 feet.

Earth / Terra, Tectonic Slam (LOCKED). As a Magic action, you can expend 1 use to make the ground erupt in a 20-foot-radius Sphere centered on a point within 120 feet of yourself. Each creature in the Sphere must succeed on a Dexterity saving throw or take 7d8 Force damage and have the Prone condition. Until the start of your next turn, the raised stone makes the area Difficult Terrain, a creature takes 5 Piercing damage for every 5 feet it moves in the area, and you and your allies have Half Cover while in the area.

Shadow / Umbra, Soul Siphon (LOCKED). As a Magic action, you can expend 1 use to target one creature within 60 feet of yourself. The target must make a Constitution saving throw, taking 8d6 Necrotic damage on a failed save or half as much damage on a successful one. You, or one ally within 30 feet of you, regains a number of Hit Points equal to half the Necrotic damage dealt.

The Sentinel

“An upgraded Eldritch Cannon, rebuilt at the bench into a faithful guardian.”

The Sentinel

Medium Construct (the Pocket Dynamo, rebuilt; Requires Attunement by Lilly)

Armor Class 18

Hit Points 5 + five times your Artificer level (40 at Level 7); it has a number of d8 Hit Dice equal to your Artificer level
Speed 30 ft.

STR 14 (+2) **DEX** 10 (+0) **CON** 16 (+3) **INT** 4 (-3) **WIS** 12 (+1) **CHA** 6 (-2)

Damage Immunities Poison

Condition Immunities Charmed, Exhaustion, Poisoned

Senses Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 11

Languages understands the languages you know

Duration. None. The Sentinel remains until it drops to 0 Hit Points or until you dismiss it (no action required). As a Bonus Action, you can deploy or recall it.

Bound Construct. Add your Proficiency Bonus to any ability check or saving throw the Sentinel makes.

Rebuilt Dynamo. The Sentinel replaces your Eldritch Cannon feature: while you are attuned to it, you deploy the Sentinel instead of a cannon, never both at once. Deploying the Sentinel doesn't expend a spell slot, and the Sentinel has no maximum duration. When the Mending spell is cast on the Sentinel, it regains 2d6 Hit Points. If the Sentinel has dropped to 0 Hit Points, you can rebuild it by expending a level 1+ spell slot.



Actions

Activate. As a Bonus Action, you can activate the Sentinel, and it then takes one of the following actions of your choice.

Force Blast. Ranged Attack Roll: Bonus equals your spell attack modifier, range 120 ft. Hit: 2d8 + your Intelligence modifier Force damage.

Electric Pulse. Dexterity Saving Throw: DC equals your spell save DC, each creature of your choice within 15 feet of the Sentinel. Failure: 2d8 + your Intelligence modifier Lightning damage, and the target can't take Reactions until the start of your next turn. Success: Half damage.

Reactions

Guardian Protocol (1/round). Trigger: An ally within 15 feet of the Sentinel takes damage. Response: The ally gains 1d8 + your Intelligence modifier Temporary Hit Points.

Why this is an upgrade. The old cannon made Lilly choose a mode; the Sentinel walks on its own 30 feet, then blasts or pulses on her Bonus Action (her pick every time), and shields her friends as a Reaction in the same round. Her old kit lives on inside it: the Force Ballista became the Force Blast, the Storm mode became the Electric Pulse, and the Protector stands watch as Guardian Protocol. The Flamethrower was traded for lightning, Gearhaven's own element. Forged by the masters of Glimmerstone.

Marks & Mysteries

Ursa's Mark of Handling. A dragonmark that woke when he was six: it prickles near frightened animals, grants Speak with Animals and Animal Friendship, and has become the channel through which sleeping and possessed things speak to him (Pikachu, the Grand Custodian). It has never once stirred for a machine.

The seven-point star. Elaria's sigil, wrapped in a leafed vine (or cupped in wings, on the Sash), found on every gift along the Guardians' path. When you see it, she saw you coming.

◆ LORE OF ELARIA ◆ The Warden's Price

Elaria spent her power the way a candle spends itself: all at once, on purpose, so others could see. When Maldrith was sealed beyond the last wall, the Warden had nothing left but her name and her sign, the seven-pointed star wrapped in a leafed vine. She scattered what remained into small safeguards and lay down to sleep, trusting the kind to find them. So far, the old tellings say, her trust has held.



◆ LORE OF ELARIA ◆ The Warden's Watch

Ask the Circle what Elaria is warden OF, and the old druids only point: at the turning planes, at the anchor-stars strung between them like a lantern-line, at the small safe things of the world that have no other reason to be safe. The tellings do not agree on why she sleeps. Some say the sealing emptied her to the last drop. Some say the sleep is itself the seal, and that waking her would open a door best left shut. The very oldest telling says she is not asleep at all, only listening, on a scale too slow and too deep for waking folk to follow. On one point every telling closes ranks: the stars her enemy puts out, her gifts relight. A staff kindles. A sash carries. A small bright core remembers. And somewhere beneath the turning of all seven planes, something that loves the world very much is dreaming it safe passage.

"She is not gone," the first druids wrote. "She is holding. When you carry her sign, hold with her."



Elaria, the sleeping goddess who lit the way.

Part IV: The Guardians' Character Sheets

Three heroes, every number and spell, exactly as they stood at the close of the Gearhaven chapter (Session 7): level 5, relics attuned, cannon smoking. These pages are the table copies, set large enough to read at arm's length, with the house rules already baked in. Ghostbloom, the party's spectral companion, closes the chapter.

Lilly Glimmergear

Deep Gnome Artificer (Artillerist), Level 5.

The inventor of the group. Lilly builds a magic cannon, zaps things with frost, and carries the Essence Sphere that holds Pikachu's spark.

► **Armor Class** 20 (+1 half plate and shield)
Hit Points 38 **Speed** 25 ft. **Initiative** +2
Proficiency +3
► **STR** 8 (-1) **DEX** 14 (+2) **CON** 14 (+2)
INT 20 (+5) **WIS** 12 (+1) **CHA** 8 (-1)
► **Spell save DC** 16 **Spell attack** +8.
Intelligence powers all her magic.

Spell Slots, 1st Level ● ● ● ●

Spell Slots, 2nd Level ● ●



Saving Throws & Skills

Saving Throws. Str -1, Dex +2, **Con +5**, **Int +8**, Wis +1, Cha -1 (bold = proficient; her best are Con and Int).

Skills. Acrobatics +2, **Animal Handling +4**, **Arcana +8**, Athletics -1, Deception -1, History +5, Insight +1, Intimidation -1, **Investigation +8**, Medicine +1, Nature +5, Perception +1, Performance -1, Persuasion -1, Religion +5, Sleight of Hand +2, Stealth +2, **Survival +4** (bold = trained; her best are Arcana and Investigation, +8).

What Lilly Does in a Fight

True Strike (frost dagger). Melee, +9 to hit. Hit: 1d4 + 1d4 cold + 6, plus 1d6 radiant, plus 1d8 + 2 frost. Her best up-close hit.

Cannon: Flamethrower. DC 16 Dex save; 2d8 + 2 fire in a 15-ft cone.

Cannon: Force Ballista. +8 to hit, range 120 ft: 2d8 + 2 force, push 5 ft.

Cannon: Protector. Shield-points (temporary HP) to Lilly and friends within 10 ft: 1d8 + 5.

Fire Bolt (cantrip). +8 to hit, range 120 ft: 2d10 fire + 1d8 + 2 frost (dagger).

► **How Lilly's turn works.** She fires her cannon as a BONUS action AND does something else with her main action (cast a spell, stab with True Strike, or Fire Bolt). She gets to do both every turn.

Lilly's Eldritch Cannon

The Eldritch Cannon

AC 18 Hit Points 25 Size Small or Tiny **Speed** 15 ft. (on little legs). It can be attacked and broken; Mending repairs it 2d6. It ignores conditions, poison, and psychic damage; enemies must smash it to 0 HP.

Pick the blast when she fires (house rule). The cannon is no longer locked to one mode. Each time she fires it, choose: Flamethrower (15-ft cone, 2d8 + 2 fire), Force Ballista (one faraway enemy, 2d8 + 2 force, push 5 ft), or Protector (shield-points to Lilly and friends within 10 ft, 1d8 + 5).

How to use it. Fire it with a bonus action, so Lilly still gets her main action the same turn. Free to deploy or recall (Pocket Dynamo), +2 damage, lasts a full 24 hours.

Special Powers & Deep Gnome Gifts

Class Features & Species Traits

Replicate Magic Item. Lilly builds magic gear for the team. Her two creations in use now: her own +1 Half Plate and the +1 Repeating Longbow she made for Stabby.

Tinker's Magic. Knows the Mending cantrip (fix broken things). Can also conjure handy mundane gear (rope, a torch, ball bearings) that lasts until her next rest. Great for puzzles and traps.

The Right Tool. With her tools, Lilly can magically make any set of artisan's tools she needs (1 hour).

Gnomish Magic Resistance. Advantage on Int, Wis, and Cha saves against spells.

Svirfneblin Camouflage. Advantage on Stealth checks.

Gift of the Svirfneblin. Casts Disguise Self and Nondetection free, 1/long rest each.

Senses & Languages. Sees in the dark 120 ft. Speaks Common, Gnomish, and Undercommon.

Lilly's Signature Gear

Lilly's Stuff

Essence Sphere. A steampunk orb holding Pikachu's spark. Lilly's big quest item: she wants to give Pikachu a body again.

Frostbite Shard Dagger +1. Her magic frost dagger (1d4 piercing + 1d4 cold). Spell focus AND arcane firearm: adds 1d8 frost to one spell she casts through it, plus +2 frost on any spell. +1 to hit.

Glimmerspire Pocket Dynamo, Mk II (Elaria's gift). From the Wraithpine chest. Summon or recall her cannon for free, lasts 24 hours, +2 damage. Reformat (1/long rest, action), now mostly spare, since every cannon picks its blast when it fires. Needs attunement.

+1 Half Plate (her creation). Half plate she replicated with Replicate Magic Item. Base of her AC 20.

Shield. A sturdy steel shield. Adds +2 to her armor.

Lilly's Spellbook

Slots per day: 4 first-level, 2 second-level. Cantrips are free forever. She prepares 7 spells; the four marked Always Prepared are free from her Artillerist subclass and don't count toward that. The +1d8 frost is her dagger's arcane firearm (it rides one spell she casts each turn), and the +2 frost rides along on any spell cast through the dagger.

Cantrips (free forever)

True Strike. Action, melee. Stab with the Frostbite dagger using INT: +9 to hit; 1d4 + 1d4 cold + 6, plus 1d6 radiant, plus 1d8 frost (arcane firearm) and 2 frost.

Fire Bolt. Action, 120 ft. Ranged spell attack +8: 2d10 fire + 1d8 + 2 frost (dagger). Her reliable ranged poke; never runs out.

Mending. 1 minute, touch. Repair a single break or tear in an object no bigger than 1 ft. Free from Tinker's Magic. Also heals her cannon 2d6!

1st-Level Spells

Shield (Always Prepared). Reaction. Snap up a force wall: +5 AC until the start of her next turn (can turn a hit into a miss) and no damage from Magic Missile.

Thunderwave (Always Prepared). Action, self (15-ft cube). Con save DC 16: on a fail, 2d8 thunder + 1d8 + 2 frost (dagger) and shoved 10 ft away; half and no shove on a success.

Absorb Elements. Reaction when she takes acid/cold/fire/lightning/thunder: take half of it, and her next melee hit deals +1d6 of that type.

Catapult. Action, 60 ft. Fling a loose object (up to 5 lb). Dex save DC 16: on a fail, 3d8 bludgeoning + 1d8 + 2 frost (dagger); no damage on a success.

Snare. 1 minute to set, touch, 8-hour trap. First creature to step in makes a Dex save DC 16 or is yanked upside-down, restrained in the air.

Faerie Fire. Action, 60 ft, concentration 1 min. Foes in a 20-ft cube, Dex save DC 16; on a fail they are outlined in light: attacks against them have advantage and they can't be invisible.

Tasha's Caustic Brew. Action, 30-ft line, concentration 1 min. Dex save or be coated in acid: 2d4 acid + 1d8 + 2 frost (dagger) at the start of each of its turns until it spends an action to wash off.

2nd-Level Spells

Scorching Ray (Always Prepared). Action, 120 ft. Three rays, each a separate ranged spell attack +8: 2d6 fire each, plus 1d8 + 2 frost (dagger, once).

Shatter (Always Prepared). Action, 60 ft (10-ft sphere). Con save DC 16: 3d8 thunder + 1d8 + 2 frost (dagger) on a fail, half on success. Extra effective against metal and stone foes.

Heat Metal. Action, 60 ft, concentration 1 min. A metal object or armor glows red-hot: 2d8 fire + 1d8 + 2 frost (dagger) instantly, and a bonus action each turn to deal it again. The holder makes a Con save or drops the item.

Web. Action, 60 ft (20-ft cube), concentration 1 hr. Sticky webs: difficult terrain, Dex save DC 16 or restrained (retry with a Str check). Locks down a crowd.

Stabby Sharpblade

Goblin Monk (Way of the Kensei), Level 5. The wild one. Stabby is a tiny, lightning-fast goblin who fights with a candy-cane katana and his own two fists. Chaos with a smile.

► **Armor Class 18 Hit Points 43 Speed 50 ft.**
Initiative +5 Proficiency +3

► **STR 8 (-1) DEX 20 (+5) CON 16 (+3) INT 8 (-1)**
WIS 14 (+2) CHA 8 (-1)

► **Focus save DC 13.** All Focus Points come back on a short rest. AC 18 normally; it jumps to 20 right after Stabby punches and swings his katana the same turn (Agile Parry). Speed and AC include his Sash.



Focus Points ● ● ● ● ●

Saving Throws & Skills

Saving Throws. **Str +2, Dex +8**, Con +3, Int -1, Wis +2, Cha -1 (bold = proficient; his best are Dex and Str).

Skills. **Acrobatics +8**, Animal Handling +2, Arcana -1, **Athletics +2**, Deception -1, History -1, Insight +2, Intimidation -1, Investigation -1, Medicine +2, Nature -1, Perception +2, Performance -1, Persuasion -1,

Sleight of Hand +5, **Stealth +8**, **Survival +5** (bold = trained; his best are Acrobatics and Stealth, +8: sneaky and springy!).

What Stabby Does in a Fight

Candyfang Katana +1. Melee, +9 to hit: 1d10 + 6 slashing + 2 cold.

Unarmed Strike (fist or foot). Melee, +8 to hit: 1d8 + 5 bludgeoning.

Repeating Longbow +1. Ranged, +9 to hit: 1d8 + 6 piercing; +1d4 via Kensei's Shot.

► **How Stabby's turn works.** He gets 2 attacks with his Attack action, PLUS 1 extra punch as a bonus action (Martial Arts). Spend Focus on Flurry of Blows for even more: up to 3 or 4 hits a turn!

Stabby's Special Moves

Focus Moves (1 Focus each)

Flurry of Blows. Spend 1 Focus as a bonus action to make two extra punches. His big damage button.

Stunning Strike. When he hits, spend 1 Focus to try to stun the enemy (Con save vs DC 13). Fail: stunned until his next turn, huge in a boss fight! Success: the enemy is still slowed (speed halved) and the next attack against it has advantage.

Patient Defense. Bonus action to Disengage for free (house rule). Spend 1 Focus to also Dodge (enemies hit him with disadvantage).

Step of the Wind. Bonus action to Dash for free. Spend 1 Focus to also Disengage and double his jump. Super zoomy.

Deflect Attack. Reaction when hit by a punch, arrow, or blade: lower the damage by 1d10 + 10. If it hits 0, spend 1 Focus to fling it back at another enemy within 5 ft (DC 13 Dex save, 2d8 + 5).

Kensei, Monk & Goblin Traits

Agile Parry. After he punches and swings his katana the same turn, he gets +2 AC until his next turn. (House rule: his bonus-action punch counts.)

Kensei's Shot. Bonus action: his next longbow hit this turn deals an extra 1d4 damage.

Slow Fall. Reaction to take 25 less falling damage.

Uncanny Metabolism. Once a day, when he rolls initiative: regain all Focus and heal 5 + 1d8 HP.

Fury of the Small. When he hits a creature bigger than him (almost everyone!), deal +3 extra damage. 3 times per long rest, once per turn.

Nimble Escape. He can Disengage or Hide as a bonus action every turn. Slippery little goblin.

Fey Ancestry. A touch of fey blood: advantage on saves to avoid or shake off the charmed condition.

Senses & Languages. Sees in the dark 60 ft. Speaks Common, Goblin, and Orc.

Stabby's Signature Gear

Stabby's Stuff

Candyfang Katana +1. His prized candy-cane katana. +1 to hit and damage, +2 cold. Sugar Rush: once a day, lick the blade (bonus action) for 2d8 + 3 temporary HP and a jolt of chaos energy.

Repeating Longbow +1. A magic bow that makes its own arrows; it never runs out. +1 to hit and damage. (Lilly made it for him.)

Sash of the Swift Current (Elaria's gift). Scarlet stage-silk from the Wraithpine chest. +1 AC, +10 ft. speed, plus Air Dance (fly for 1 minute, 1/day) and Feather Fall (1/day). Attuned.

Explorer's Pack. Backpack, bedroll, rope, torches, rations: the usual adventuring kit.

► **Fun facts.** Stabby is a boy goblin, age 8, just 2 feet 4 inches tall and 30 pounds: small but mighty! Green skin, red eyes, green hair. He carries a creepy little idol that gives him

strange dreams, and his old clan, the Bloodfang, are part of his past (and maybe future allies).

Ursa Catchum

Human (Mark of Handling) Druid (Circle of the Stars), Level 5. The starwatcher. Ursa reads the night sky like a map, calls down starlight and beast-spirits, and follows the constellations toward his destiny.

► **Armor Class** 18 (spiked armor and shield) **Hit Points** 38 **Speed** 30 ft. **Initiative** +2 **Proficiency** +3

► **STR** 8 (-1) **DEX** 14 (+2) **CON** 14 (+2) **INT** 12 (+1) **WIS** 20 (+5) **CHA** 8 (-1)

► **Spell save DC** 16 **Spell attack** +8. Wisdom powers all his magic. Passive Perception 18: almost nothing sneaks past him.

Spell Slots, 1st Level ● ● ● ●

Spell Slots, 2nd Level ● ● ●

Spell Slots, 3rd Level ● ●



Saving Throws & Skills

Saving Throws. Str -1, Dex +2, Con +2, **Int +4**, **Wis +8**, Cha -1 (bold = proficient; his best are Wis and Int).

Skills. Acrobatics +2, **Animal Handling +8**, Arcana +1, Athletics -1, Deception -1, History +1, Insight +5, Intimidation -1, Investigation +1, Medicine +5, Nature +1, **Perception +8**, Performance -1, Persuasion -1, Religion +1, Sleight of Hand +2, Stealth +2, **Survival +8** (bold = trained; his best are Animal Handling, Perception, and Survival, +8).

What Ursa Does in a Fight

Staff of Waking Constellations (+1), unlit. Melee, +3 (+4) to hit: 1d6 bludgeoning (1d8 two-handed). See Shillelagh!

Staff + Shillelagh (ignited). Melee, +9 (+10) to hit: 1d10 + 6 force or bludgeoning. Bonus action to light, lasts 1 minute.

Guiding Bolt (1st, from Staff or Star Map). +8 (+9) to hit, 120 ft: 4d6 radiant + 1d4 (Starseed); the next hit on that target has advantage.

Star-Arrow (Starry Form: Archer). Bonus action, +8 (+9) to hit: 1d8 + 5 radiant, one enemy within 60 ft.

Starry Wisp (cantrip). +8 (+9) to hit, 60 ft: 2d8 radiant + 1d4 (Starseed); lights up the target.

The number in (parentheses) is his to-hit while his Starry Form is glowing: the Amulet of Guiding Light gives +1 to attacks (and saves) for him and nearby friends. He keeps it on, so that's usually his real number.

► **How Ursa's turn works.** His summoned spirit acts on its own turn for free; Ursa just tells it what to do. His bonus action each turn goes to one move: fire a star-arrow (Starry Form: Archer), move a Moonbeam or Flaming Sphere, cast Healing Word, or ignite Shillelagh. And he still casts a spell or cantrip with his action the same turn.

► **Free Guiding Bolts.** Before touching his real spell slots, he can throw about 8 Guiding Bolts a day for free: 3 from the Star Map (per long rest) plus up to 5 from the Staff's charges. **Starseed (+1d4 radiant).** Once a turn, rides his druid spells that deal radiant damage (Guiding Bolt, Moonbeam, Starry Wisp), NOT the Archer arrow (a form feature, not a spell; house rule).

Ursa's Special Powers

Class Features & Mark of Handling

Starry Form (Bonus Action). Spend a Wild Shape use to glow with starlight (10-ft bright light, 10 min). Pick a constellation each time: **Archer** (bonus action: a star-arrow at one enemy within 60 ft, 1d8 + 5 radiant), **Chalice** (when he heals someone with a spell slot, he or a nearby friend also heals 1d8 + 5), or **Dragon** (treat a roll of 9 or lower as a 10 on Int and Wis checks and concentration saves).

Wild Shape (2 uses). Two uses that fuel his Starry Forms (or turn into a beast he has seen). Regain 1 on a short rest, all on a long rest.

Wild Resurgence. Once per turn (no action), spend a spell slot to get back one Wild Shape use. And once per long rest, the reverse: spend a Wild Shape use (no action) to regain a 1st-level spell slot.

Star Map. His star chart is a magic focus. Free Guiding Bolt 3/day even without the Staff. Backup focus he still carries.

Wild Intuition. Add 1d4 to any Animal Handling or Nature check.

Primal Connection (1/short rest). Cast Animal Friendship or Speak with Animals for free, no materials; they're always ready and never use up a prepared spell.

The Bigger They Are. Can charm or talk to beasts AND monstrosities (if their Intelligence is 3 or lower).

Mark of Handling. His dragonmark lets him read animals' feelings and calm wild or magical creatures with ease.

Ursa's Summoned Spirits

Bestial Spirit (Summon Beast, 2nd). AC 13, HP 30 (Air: 20, house rule), Speed 40 ft. (Land), or fly/swim 30 ft. Pick Air, Land, or Water when summoned. Maul/Rend: +8 to hit, 1d8 + 6, 1 attack. Flyby (Air): no opportunity attacks. Great scout and striker; shares Ursa's turn and obeys his commands for free.

Fey Spirit (Summon Fey, 3rd). AC 15, HP 30, Speed 40 ft., fly 40 ft. Fey Blade: +8 to hit, 2d6 + 6 force, 1 attack. Fey Step: teleport up to 30 ft., then its mood triggers. Fuming: advantage on its next attack this turn. Mirthful: foe within 10 ft., Wis save DC 16 or Charmed. Tricksy: fills a 10-ft cube with magical Darkness.

Ursa's Signature Gear

Ursa's Stuff

Staff of Waking Constellations (Elaria's gift). His Wraithpine relic. +1 quarterstaff and druidic focus. Holds 5 charges (regain 1d4 + 1 at dawn): Guiding Bolt (1), Faerie Fire (1), Moonbeam (2). Starseed: once a turn, when a druid spell deals radiant damage, add +1d4 radiant. Starlight: bonus action to light a soft 10-ft glow and get advantage on night navigation. Attuned.

Star Map. A Tiny star chart that doubles as a spellcasting focus. Free Guiding Bolt 3/day. (Backup focus.)

Amulet of Guiding Light. Guiding Light: during Starry Form, Ursa and allies in the bright light get +1 to attacks and saves. Starry Glow (1/day, reaction): when he or a nearby ally is hit, the attacker takes 2d8 radiant and may be blinded (Con save DC 15). Celestial Resilience (2/day): reroll a natural 1.

Three Enchanted Potatoes. His mysterious quest trinket: the strange spuds tied to his father's disappearance.

Spiked Armor & Shield. Dwarf-made spiked armor plus a shield; together they make his AC 18.

Explorer's Pack. Backpack, bedroll, mess kit, tinderbox, 10 torches, 10 days of rations, waterskin, 50 ft. of rope.

Ursa's Spellbook

Slots per day: 4 first-level, 3 second-level, 2 third-level. Cantrips are free forever. He prepares 9 spells (2024 rules) and can swap one on a long rest, and he stretches them: Speak with Animals and Animal Friendship come free from his Mark of Handling, and Faerie Fire fires from the Staff's charges, so none of those use his 9. Spell save DC 16, spell attack +8.

Cantrips (free forever)

Shillelagh. Bonus action, self, 1 minute. Starlight sheathes his staff: for 1 minute it swings with WISDOM, +9 to hit (+10 in Starry Form), 1d10 + 6 force or bludgeoning, his choice. Recast any time. His answer when something gets right in his face. (House rule: replaces Primal Savagery, 2024 rules.)

Starry Wisp. Action, 60 ft. Ranged spell attack +8: 2d8 radiant + 1d4 (Starseed). The target glows (dim light) and can't turn invisible until the end of his next turn.

Guidance. Action, touch, concentration 1 min. Once before it ends, a willing friend adds 1d4 to one ability check (roll the d4 after seeing the result).

Druidcraft. Action, 30 ft. Tiny nature magic: predict the next 24 hours of weather, bloom a flower, make a harmless sound or smell, or light and snuff a small flame.

1st-Level Spells

Guiding Bolt. Action, 120 ft (Star Map: free 3/day). Ranged spell attack +8: 4d6 radiant + 1d4 (Starseed), and the next attack against that target before Ursa's next turn has advantage.

Healing Word. Bonus action, 60 ft. Heal one creature he can see 2d4 + 5 HP, and he can still cast a cantrip or attack the same turn. Best for popping a downed friend back up from range.

Goodberry. Action, touch, lasts 24 hr. Creates 10 berries; eating one is a Bonus Action (2024 rules) and heals 1 HP and feeds someone for a day. Cast before a fight to bank 10 little heals.

Faerie Fire (via Staff charge). Action, 60 ft, concentration 1 min. Foes in a 20-ft cube, Dex save DC 16; on a fail they are outlined in light: attacks against them have advantage and they can't hide or turn invisible. Cast from the Staff (1 charge), so it doesn't use a prepared slot.

Speak with Animals (free, Mark). Ritual, action, self, 10 min. Talk with beasts: they can describe nearby places, monsters, and what they've seen. Free once per short rest from his Mark of Handling.

Animal Friendship (free, Mark). Action, 30 ft, 24 hr. One beast (Int 3 or lower) makes a Wis save DC 16 or is charmed and friendly for 24 hours. With The Bigger They Are, he can target dumb monstrosities too. Free once per short rest from his Mark.

2nd-Level Spells

Moonbeam. Action, 120 ft, concentration 1 min (Staff: 2 charges). A 5-ft pillar of light. Con save DC 16 when the beam appears on a creature, when it enters, or when it ends its turn there: 2d10 radiant + 1d4 (Starseed) on a fail, half on a success. Move it 60 ft each turn as part of the spell.

Flaming Sphere. Action, 60 ft, concentration 1 min. A 5-ft fire ball. A creature ending its turn within 5 ft makes a Dex save DC 16: 2d6 fire on a fail, half on success. Bonus action to roll it 30 ft (ram a foe to force the save).

Spike Growth. Action, 150 ft, concentration 10 min. A 20-ft circle of ground sprouts hidden thorns: difficult terrain, and 2d4 piercing for every 5 ft a creature moves through. It looks like normal ground; herd foes across it or drop it under a charging monster.

Summon Beast. Action, 90 ft, concentration 1 hr. Calls the Bestial Spirit (stats above). It acts right after Ursa on his initiative and obeys his commands for free. His go-to summon: a sturdy front-line ally that lasts a whole hour.

3rd-Level Spells

Call Lightning. Action, 120 ft, concentration 10 min. Make a storm cloud; each turn, use an action to strike: creatures within 5 ft of the point make a Dex save DC 16, 3d10 lightning on a fail, half on success. +1d10 if it's already stormy.

Summon Fey. Action, 90 ft, concentration 1 hr. Calls the Fey Spirit (stats above). Faster and hits harder than the beast, with a mood power and a 30-ft teleport. Acts on Ursa's turn and obeys him for free.

The Party's Companion: Ghostbloom

Once the party's little plant-friend Floraburst, reborn in Wraithpine's ghost-light as a pale, glowing, chiming spirit who floats beside the Guardians.

Ghostbloom, Spectral Blossom

Tiny Fey (Ghost/Grass), Chaotic Good, Companion of the Guardians

Armor Class 15

Hit Points 52 (8d4 + 32)

Speed 30 ft., fly 30 ft. (hover)

STR 8 (-1) **DEX** 18 (+4) **CON** 18 (+4) **INT** 12 (+1) **WIS** 14 (+2) **CHA** 16 (+3)

Saving Throws Dex +7, Con +7, Wis +5

Skills Perception +5, Stealth +7

Damage Resistances Necrotic; nonmagical attacks

Damage Vulnerabilities Fire, Cold (mind the friendly fire!)

Condition Immunities Charmed, Frightened

Senses Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 15

Languages Sylvan, telepathy 30 ft.

Fey Step (1/Short Rest). As a bonus action, teleport up to 20 feet to an unoccupied space you can see. Your next attack roll before the end of your turn has advantage.

Spectral Form. You can move through other creatures and objects as if they were difficult terrain. If you end your turn inside an object, you are shunted to the nearest unoccupied space and take 5 force damage.

Guardian's Light (3/Short Rest). *Reaction, 30 ft.* When an ally you can see takes damage, that ally regains 1d8 + 3 hit points and immediately ends the charmed or frightened condition on itself.



Actions

Multiattack. Ghostbloom makes two Spectral Lash attacks.

Spectral Lash. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 15 ft., one target. *Hit:* 1d8 + 5 slashing plus 1d6 necrotic damage, and the target must succeed on a DC 15 Wisdom saving throw or be frightened until the end of its next turn.

Ghostly Wail (1/Long Rest). A haunting cry in a 15-foot cone. Each creature in that area must succeed on a DC 15 Wisdom saving throw, taking 4d6 necrotic damage on a failed save, or half as much on a success. On a failed save, the target is frightened until the end of its next turn.

Dread Shroud. *Bonus Action; 30 ft.; one creature.* A chill bloom settles over the target. It must succeed on a DC 15 Wisdom save or suffer disadvantage on all attack rolls until the start of your next turn.

► **Running Ghostbloom at the table.** Guardian's Light is the party's safety net: budget it (3 per short rest) and save one for the boss. Ghostbloom fears the rifts: play its guttering glow near planar wrongness, and let helping cost it courage. And keep it well clear of Lilly's flamethrower cone and cold bursts; fire and cold hit it double.